Form in Beethoven's Instrumental Works: A Critical Examination of Vincent d'Indy's *Cours de composition musicale*

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A thesis submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements

for the degree of

Maîtrise ès arts

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November 2024

Résumé

Le *Cours de composition musicale* de Vincent d'Indy (1903-1950) a fait l'objet de critiques minutieuses de la littérature musicologique récente pour la charge idéologique qui imprègne son discours [Groth, 1983, Donin and Campos, 2006, Ellis, 2006, Pasler, 2008, Suchowiejko, 2006, Campos, 2013, de Médicis, 2024]. Dans une perspective complémentaire, ce projet de recherche cherche à tester la théorie formelle de d'Indy pour l'analyse des œuvres instrumentales de Beethoven de manière à en évaluer la pertinence. Cela sera effectué de deux manières principales : par un examen de la cohérence de la théorie d'indyste, réalisé à travers son vocabulaire analytique et son application de ces concepts aux œuvres de Beethoven, ainsi que par la confrontation avec une des théories formelles les plus fines développées dans ces dernières années pour l'étude de la musique instrumentale classique, celle de William Caplin (*Classical Form* [1998] et *Analyzing Classical Form* [2013]).

Ce projet apporte plusieurs contributions significatives. L'auteur montre que les concepts théoriques de d'Indy, bien qu'ils soient formulés avec un souci évident de rigueur et de clarté, ne sont pas entièrement explicités et ouvrent la voie à différentes interprétations, et par conséquent, à différentes analyses. En identifiant les valeurs de d'Indy et leur influence sur ses analyses, le projet met en lumière l'empreinte idéologique de sa pensée. Enfin, il montre que certaines de ses idées, bien que partielles, anticipent des concepts et des schémas observés plus tard dans des théories de *Formenlehre* ultérieures. Cette perspective permet ainsi de réexaminer la place de d'Indy dans l'évolution de l'analyse formelle et de réévaluer sa contribution à l'histoire de la théorie musicale.

Mots clés: Vincent d'Indy, William Caplin, Forme Sonate, Beethoven, Théorie, Analyse Musicale, Composition, Pédagogie

Abstract

Vincent d'Indy's *Cours de composition musicale* (1903-1950) has been the subject of meticulous scrutiny by recent musicological literature for the ideological charge that permeates its discourse [Groth, 1983, Donin and Campos, 2006, Ellis, 2006, Pasler, 2008, Suchowiejko, 2006, Campos, 2013, de Médicis, 2024]. From a complementary perspective, this research project seeks to test d'Indy's formal theory for the analysis of Beethoven's instrumental works to assess its relevance. This will be carried out in two main ways: through an examination of the coherence of the Indyist theory, achieved through his analytical vocabulary and his application of these concepts to Beethoven's works, as well as by confrontation with one of the most refined formal theories developed in recent years for the study of classical instrumental music, that of William Caplin (*Classical Form* [1998] and *Analyzing Classical Form* [2013]).

This research is offers contributions on several fronts. The author shows that d'Indy's theoretical concepts, although formulated with an evident concern for rigor and clarity, are not fully explicated and pave the way for different interpretations, and consequently, different analyses. By identifying d'Indy's values and their influence on his analyses, the project sheds light on the ideological imprint of his thought. Finally, it shows that some of his ideas, albeit partial, anticipate concepts and patterns observed later in subsequent *Formenlehre* theories. This perspective thus allows for a re-examination of d'Indy's place in the evolution of formal analysis and a reevaluation of his contribution to the history of music theory.

Keywords: Vincent d'Indy, William Caplin, Sonata Form, Beethoven, Theory, Musical Analysis, Composition, Pedagogy

Acknowledgments

I would like to extend my sincere thanks to my supervisor Prof. François de Médicis for the excellent topic suggestion and for his guidance and open-minded support throughout my research. I would also like to thank Observatoire interdisciplinaire de création et de recherche en musique (OICRM), especially the Équipe Musique en France (ÉMF), for their generous funding that significantly supported my research path.

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Context

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Introduction

1.1 Subject of the Dissertation

Vincent d'Indy's contributions to musical composition and education have established him as a pivotal figure in late nineteenth and early twentieth-century French music. While d'Indy presents himself as Franck's spokesperson, his theory exhibits a high degree of individuality and freely appropriates Franck's ideas. Jann Pasler endows, "his [d'Indy's] conception of Franckism as an oppositional current in French music, a parallel to Wagnerism, eventually fashioned him as the disciple of Franck by helping a group identity coalesce and a lineage begin" [Pasler, 2008]. At the Schola Cantorum, which he helped establish, his educational philosophy promoted an integrated and organic approach to musical training, influencing the curricular frameworks of the study of music history, performance and composition. This educational philosophy extended to his theoretical works, notably seen in his *Cours de composition musicale*, where he articulates a structured, yet flexible approach to musical form [d'Indy, 1903] [d'Indy, 1909] [d'Indy, 1933] [d'Indy, 1950].

This research project aims to test d'Indy's formal theories by applying them to the analysis of Beethoven's instrumental works. It examines key elements of d'Indy's approach, such as the division of a piece of music into units of varying lengths, his articulation techniques, and his description of formal functions. By clarifying d'Indy's system in verbalizing what remains implicit in his definitions, and by adopting a critical view to his analytical system, this study seeks to offer new insights into his methodological consistency.

1.2 Literature Review

Campos and Donin describe d'Indy as "the first figure in France to adopt new practice," moving between "musical writing and writing about music," while promoting performers and standards consistent with his theoretical framework. They note that "d'Indy's poetics, which implies the systematic control by the author over composition, performance, listening, teaching, and commentary, would become more radical as the musician's life progressed." [1]

This portrayal of d'Indy as a pioneering figure is further complemented by Ellis, who suggests that d'Indy was "perhaps the first to write a history of musical style and genre that is more dependent on 'resonances' than on the establishment or presentation of music-historical 'facts'" [Ellis, 2006, p. 111]. According to Ellis, d'Indy constructs a historiographical lineage in his *Cours de composition*, emphasizing a compositional "resonance" between figures like Palestrina, Bach, and Beethoven, linking them to Wagner's ideals of "interior expression over external effect," but omits César Franck, with whom he had a uniquely influential mentor-student relationship. Furthermore, Ellis highlights how d'Indy's *Cours* reflects his ideological commitment to a moralized view of music history, where composers are judged according to their alignment with Wagnerian principles, underscoring the "parallel

[1] Campos and Donin originaly wrote, "En France, Vincent d'Indy est la première figure à adopter cette nouvelle pratique : compositeur de premier plan, auteur de textes théoriques [...], il a lui-même sans cesse opéré le va-et-vient entre écriture musicale et écriture sur la musique, en même temps qu'il promouvait des interprètes et des standards d'interprétation cohérents avec ces écritures. La poétique d'indyste, qui suppose le contrôle systématique par l'auteur de la composition, de l'exécution, de l'écoute, de l'enseignement et du commentaire, ira en se radicalisant au cours de la vie du musicien et connaîtra tout au long du siècle, outre ses avatars français, de nombreux équivalents dans d'autres courants esthétiques européens dont une étude transversale est à espérer." [Donin and Campos, 2006, pp. 155-6]

struggles between the good and the bad, the pure and the impure" [Ellis, 2006, p. 112]. This idealistic framework suggests a vision of music as a moral and aesthetic force, moving toward a higher, almost spiritual purpose.

However, the idealism of d'Indy's approach was not mere intellectual fantasies, free from connections to the empirical world. In her critical examination, "Archéologue malgré lui: Vincent d'Indy et les usages de l'histoire," Annegret Fauser discovered that "the positivist training of d'Indy, studying law in the tradition of Auguste Comte, adds a systematic current to the historical edifice that is reflected in the very construction of the *Cours de composition musicale*."[2] This foundation is reflected not only in its historical methodology (chronology, biographical elements) but also in d'Indy's application of empirical methods to music analysis, particularly his formative analysis of Beethoven's works.

D'Indy's positivist background shaped his preference for structure and formal rigor over subjective expression. Suchowiejko points out that d'Indy was critical of what he perceived as the unrestrained subjectivity of Romantic composers, such as Schubert and Chopin, whom he criticized for their "lack of formal conscience" and whose works, he believed, lacked the structural discipline he championed. Central to d'Indy's teaching was the "dogme de la forme"—the belief that form was not merely a tool but a guiding principle in composition [Suchowiejko, 2006, p. 103]. Suchowiejko notes that this rejection of subjectivity in favor of formalism is central to d'Indy's pedagogical approach, where students were taught to prioritize form as the foundation of musical composition.

D'Indy's commitment to formalism naturally extended into his structuralist and functionalist approach, where the roles of harmonic, melodic, and rhythmic elements were analyzed in relation to the whole. According to Campos' 2013 article, d'Indy's theory has been original by applying the concept of tonality across all musical phenomena, defining tonality in a way that encompasses rhythm, melody, and harmony,

[2] Fauser originally wrote, "la formation positiviste de d'Indy, étudiant en droit dans la tradition d'Auguste Comte, ajoute un courant systématique à l'édifice historique qui se reflète dans la construction même du Cours de composition musicale"[Fauser, 2006, p.124].

unlike theories who considered these elements separately.[3] By integrating Rameau's harmonic theories with Riemann's functionalism, d'Indy sought to create a cohesive system linking these elements through their tonal functions.[4]

Historical knowledge is seen not as objective or neutral, but as constructed by specific discourses and power relations. De Médicis challenges d'Indy's tendency to centralize Beethoven's influence through his historiographical narratives, particularly in his studies of César Franck, thereby addressing the gap left by Ellis. Despite d'Indy's assertion that "Franck's cyclic writing is rooted directly in the works of Beethoven's third period, independently from any other European composer" [de Médicis, 2024, p. 75], de Médicis advocates for a more pluralistic and decentralized perspective, comparing Franck's work to those of other composers, including Brahms and Liszt. By questioning the stability and objectivity of d'Indy's claims, de Médicis argues that these claims do not align with Franck's actual intentions, nor with what can be concluded through a critical evaluation of the facts.

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The existing reviews suggest a strong focus on d'Indy's theoretical and pedagogical approaches, his historical narratives, and his systematic control over musical processes. Yet, several areas appear underexplored or insufficiently critiqued.

The assessments of music theory centering on Beethoven's Sonata form within the scope of *Cours de composition musicale* remain underexplored. While Campos illustrated this functionalist approach through d'Indy's analysis of Beethoven's

[3] Campos wrote, "Son originalité est d'appliquer la notion à 'l'ensemble des phénomènes musicaux', en décrétant un terme de comparaison unique que d'Indy baptise du nom de tonique[...] La tonalité concerne donc aussi bien le rythme et la mélodie que l'harmonie" [Campos, 2013, pp. 75-7].

[4] Campos wrote, "En posant que le principe de la tonalité permet 'de rattacher, à l'aide de la tonalité harmonique la résonance harmonique et la tonique,' d'Indy mêle habilement une version modernisée de la théorie ramiste et un fonctionnalisme inspiré des thèses de Riemann" [Campos, 2013, p. 77].

"Hammerklavier" and "Lebewohl" Sonatas, the discussion on d'Indy's analytical method tends to be descriptive, focusing mainly on reporting d'Indy's assertions rather than critically engaging with the music theory itself [Campos, 2013, pp. 79-84]. This leaves potentials for exploration and original critique, particularly in examining the internal coherence of d'Indy's theoretical framework and in assessing whether d'Indy's theories consistently hold up when applied to his given musical examples.

In order for criticism to be effective, it is necessary to introduce materials beyond d'Indy's text. De Médicis engaged only with d'Indy's claims on stylistic lineage and with the author's theory of cyclic form (as other scholars before de Médicis). But nobody has engaged in the other aspects (and more basic elements) of d'Indy's theory of form. However, bringing in a contemporary theory to confront d'Indy's—using the same examples to expose discrepancies—offers a contrasting way to reevaluate the theory. Furthermore, while de Médicis successfully deconstructs some of d'Indy's claims, some of them remain open-ended questions. A reconstruction of d'Indy's theory in light of contemporary insights could be revealing.

1.3 Methodology

1.3.1 Examination of Internal Coherence

A structured analysis of d'Indy's theoretical terminology and values is conducted to establish clarity and highlight his core ideas. This involves:

1. Defining key terms and concepts by situating them within a structured hierarchy, showing their interrelationships to build a foundational understanding of d'Indy's analytical vocabulary.

2. Engaging with d'Indy's analyses to assess the clarity and coherence of his theoretical assertions. This includes identifying any contradictions or ambiguous points within his analyses and providing explanations or justifications where needed to clarify his theoretical framework.

3. Identifying underlying values by examining how his theoretical constructs prioritize elements, drawing parallels to a few other music theorists, and using these comparisons to provide a more grounded perspective on d'Indy's theoretical stance.

1.3.2 Comparative Analysis with Contemporary Theories

A comparative analysis is conducted between d'Indy's theoretical interpretations and those posited by modern theorists, such as William Caplin, in their analyses of Beethoven's compositions. This involves:

1. Identifying works where the two scholars have provided analyses of multiple passages, with a particular focus on shared analyses within Beethoven's works to establish a common foundation for comparison.

2. Identifying discrepancies in their respective analyses within the exposition section, assessing the analytical limitations of d'Indy's work, and speculating on possible reasons for these limitations through comparison.

3. Examining the same passages analyzed by both scholars, referring back to previously developed concepts, drawing parallels, and using Caplin's more modern theory to address ambiguities in d'Indy's analyses, to explore whether there is a modern equivalent for d'Indy's expressions.

1.4 Outline

Chapter 2 introduces the necessary analytical frameworks for conducting comparative analyses, focusing primarily on Vincent d'Indy's theoretical approaches and key concepts centering around the exposition section of Beethoven's Sonata form, which are essential for understanding the analyses that follow, as well as his core values, which resonate with broader theoretical foundations in his contemporary.

This chapter serves as a foundational prerequisite by establishing a detailed understanding of d'Indy's views. Additionally, it provides a brief overview of William Caplin's analytical framework, offering readers the necessary context to appreciate the comparative aspects discussed later.

Chapter 3 delves into contrasting the exposition sections of three sonata movements, reinforcing the theoretical frameworks established in the previous chapter. It begins by contrasting the interpretations of Beethoven's 5th Symphony, highlighting differences in thematic organization and refining Caplinian analysis with insights drawn from d'Indy's approach.

As the analysis progresses, the discussion of subsequent repertoire builds upon the theoretical ideas articulated in the initial analysis. A similar setup is employed for the discussion of the "Hammerklavier" Sonata in Chapter 4, beginning with the discussion of the generation of the main theme, that serves as a second example enhancing the consistency of the application of d'Indy's theory. This section then also tackles discrepancies in labeling the transition and subordinate theme.

The final chapter, Chapter 5 synthesizes the findings from the comparative analysis, explaining the reasons behind the discrepancies observed between the theories of d'Indy and Caplin. It critiques the methodologies and makes general statements about the conditions that may render one theoretical approach more effective than another. This chapter aims to provide a reflective critique that could influence future theoretical developments in music analysis.

Chapter 2

Analytical Framework

2.1 Introduction

To ensure an analysis has some foreshadowing, it is important to present the analytical frameworks to be compared beforehand. The pertinent frameworks are drawn from chapters III and IV of Vincent d'Indy's *Cours de composition musicale*: Book 2 - Part 1 [d'Indy, 1909]. For Caplin's approach, the framework is derived from his *Classical Form* [Caplin, 1998] and *Analyzing Classical Form* [Caplin, 2013], as well as classic articles such as "Expanded Cadential Progression" [Caplin, 1987].

2.2 Indy's 3 volumes

Vincent d'Indy authored three volumes of his *Cours de Composition Musicale*, a significant work in music theory. The first volume was published in 1903 by A. Durand et Fils in Paris. This initial publication laid the foundation for the subsequent parts of the series. The second volume was released in two parts: the first part was published in 1909 and the second part in 1933, written with the collaboration of Auguste Sérieyx based on notes taken from composition classes at the Schola Cantorum. The third and final volume was edited by Guy de Lioncourt and published in 1950 by Durand et Co. Rémy Campos highlights how the sequence of topics in the books follows the unfolding of the 3-year curriculum at the Schola

Cantorum:

> In the first year, students study "the purely rhythmic and melodic forms of Gregorian Monody and Folk Song, then the polyphonic forms of the Motet and Madrigal, stopping at the beginning of the 17th century." The following year, the fugue is taught not "as a writing exercise but as a form of musical composition"; students also study the instrumental suite and "the Sonata in its three manifestations (the early Italian sonata, the Beethovenian sonata, and the modern cyclic form sonata)." In the third year, the master addresses the art of orchestration as well as the "forms of the Concerto and Concert, Symphony, Chamber Music, String Quartet, Variation, Fantasy, Overture, and Symphonic Poem." Finally, the last two years are dedicated to musical drama, from the birth of opera in the 17th century to the most modern works. [Campos, 2013, pp. 72-3, *translation mine*]

The first volume covers both fundamental musical parameters and a chronological survey of vocal and instrumental genres. On one hand, it addresses foundational elements such as rhythm, melody, notation, harmony, tonality, and expression, providing a solid theoretical basis for musical understanding and practice. On the other hand, it traces the historical development of vocal genres—including monophonic chant, motets, songs, and madrigals—from the Middle Ages through the Renaissance, situating these forms within the progressive evolution of musical art. This comprehensive approach reflects d'Indy's desire to establish a solid theoretical foundation for composers.

The second volume, published in two parts, delves into later instrumental genres. The first part addresses the fugue, the suite, pre-Beethoven sonatas, Beethoven's sonatas, the cyclic sonata, and variations. The second part focuses on larger-scale forms, discussing the concerto, the symphony, chamber music with accompaniment, the string quartet, the symphonic overture, the symphonic poem, and the fantasia.

The third volume is dedicated to dramatic music, with chapters on oratorio,

Chapter	**Content**
Chapter 1	Rythme
Chapter 2	Mélodie
Chapter 3	Notation
Chapter 4	La Cantilène Monodique
Chapter 5	La Chanson Populaire
Chapter 6	L'Harmonie
Chapter 7	La Tonalité
Chapter 8	L'Expression
Chapter 9	Histoire des Théories Harmoniques
Chapter 10	Le Motet
Chapter 11	La Chanson et le Madrigal
Chapter 12	L'Évolution Progressive de l'Art

Table 2.1: Book 1 Chapters

Chapter	**Content**
Chapter 1	Fugue
Chapter 2	La Suite
Chapter 3	Sonate Pré-Beethovénienne
Chapter 4	La Sonate de Beethoven
Chapter 5	La Sonate Cyclique
Chapter 6	Variation

Table 2.2: Book 2 - Part 1 Chapters

Chapter	Content
Chapter 1	Le Concert et le Concerto à Soliste
Chapter 2	La Symphonie Proprement Dite
Chapter 3	La Musique de Chambre Accompagnée
Chapter 4	Le Quatuor à Cordes Seules
Chapter 5	L'Ouverture Symphonique
Chapter 6	Le Poème Symphonique et la Fantaisie

Table 2.3: Book 2 - Part 2 Chapters

cantata, incidental music, and the lied. This final volume markes a shift from the instrumental forms explored in the earlier volumes to vocal and stage-based genres.

Chapter	Content
Chapter 1	La Musique Dramatique
Chapter 2	L'Oratorio et la Cantate
Chapter 3	La Musique de Scène
Chapter 4	Le Lied

Table 2.4: Book 3 Chapters

Each chapter of these three books is divided into two parts: "Technique" and "Historique." The "Technique" section focuses on the structural elements of musical genres and forms, while the "Historique" section looks at their historical development. For example, in Chapter 2 of book II, the "Technique" section addresses the definitions, origins of the suite (such as the transcription of songs for instruments and the modulating binary form), and the analysis of various movements (slow, moderate, and rapid). The "Historique" section then examines the historical development of the suite, focusing on early precursors and the contributions of Italian, French, and German composers.

The primary focus on the theory of form can be found in Chapter 3 of Volume II, where d'Indy outlines essential aspects of musical structure. However, the larger structural considerations relevant to Beethoven's music are interspersed throughout the volumes, making it necessary to examine these sections in the broader context of his writings. For instance, the concept of sonata form in the current chapter builds on the foundation laid in the previous chapter, where d'Indy explains the pre-Beethovenian sonata form. Additionally, a walkthrough of Beethoven's symphonic work is found in Chapter 2 of Part II of the same volume, providing further opportunities to apply and detail d'Indy's theory.

2.3 Beethovenian Sonata Form

2.3.1 Overview of Pre-Beethovenian Sonata Form

In chapter III of Book 2 - Part 2 Pre-Beethovenian Sonata, d'Indy categorizes pre-beethovenian sonatas into two types: the monothematic sonata, containing one theme, and the dithematic sonata form, containing two themes.

While d'Indy dedicates a single chapter to Beethovenian sonatas later, his broader perspective on the structure of Beethovenian sonatas can be seen as an expansion of the architecture of the dithematic sonata form presented in the Pre-Beethovenian Sonata Chapter.

It is sufficient to acknowledge this fact without presenting the complete analytical framework for the pre-Beethovenian dithematic sonata form, as its architecture generally aligns with common sense or textbook standards of sonata form. According to this nomenclature, however, the classification of two themes suggests that d'Indy emphasizes a duality of themes rather than contrasting tonal regions within the exposition.

2.3.2 Beethovenian Sonata Form

Since the architecture of the Beethovenian sonata form is inherited from the skeleton of the dithematic sonata form introduced in the previous chapter, this chapter focuses on the generation of musical ideas and the techniques used to develop these ideas, with a particular emphasis on modulation techniques.

2.3.3 Chapter 3 of Volume II "Beethovenian Sonata" - An Overview

In the first half, "Technique" section [d'Indy, 1909, pp. 232-323], begins with a discussion of d'indyst notions such as *L'idée musicale*, *Développement*[1], *Modulation*, and the four main movement types found in the sonata form according to him.

The discussion of the *Idée musicale* focuses on addressing the structure and development of musical ideas. D'Indy introduces the cell as the smallest indivisible unit (rhythmic, melodic, or harmonic), which combines into periods and phrases to express a full musical idea. D'Indy emphasizes that this hierarchy—cell, period, phrase—is central to the work of composers like Beethoven, Wagner, and Franck. He also accentuates on the generative period, which contains the primary theme and acts as the foundation for the development of other periods and phrases. This process, central to Beethoven's sonata form, allows the musical idea to evolve while maintaining thematic unity. D'Indy uses examples such as the beginning measures of Beethoven's Piano Sonata Op. 106 and Symphony no. 5, Op. 67 to illustrate these concepts.

In discussing the notions of *Développement* and *Modulation*, d'Indy identifies two types of developments: organic and tonal. Organic development manipulates rhythmic, melodic, or harmonic elements, while tonal development focuses on the stability and modulation of keys. He highlights three types of modulation (accidental, passing, definitive) and their impact on the intensity and emotional direction of a piece.

The section then outlines the specific movement types found in sonata form: the *Mouvement Initial* (Type S, corresponding to a movement of sonata form), the *Movement Lent* (Type L, where the tempo is slow), the *Mouvement Modéré* (Type M, which includes the Menuet and Scherzo), and the *Mouvement Rapide* (Type R, such as the Rondo). In *Mouvement Initial*, d'Indy introduced a comprehensive

[1] In this context, *Développement* does not designate a formal section, but the technique of developing the musical idea, such as transform it over the course of a movement.

walk through of the first movement of Beethoven's Piano Sonata Op. 106, illustrating how the structural units—cell, period, and phrase—function within a complete movement.

The second half, "Historique" section, provides a chronological examination of Beethoven's sonatas. It starts with the Chronology of Beethoven's Sonatas, giving context to the evolution of his style over time. This is followed by an analysis of Beethoven's Piano Sonatas, categorized into three distinct time periods: the **First time period** up to 1800, the **Second time period** up to 1815, and the **Third time period** from 1815 to 1826, in which each of Beethoven's 32 sonatas is briefly analyzed.[2] While some are only presented with an overview of the movement types and a basic description of their structural organization, the majority include more detailed illustrations of specific themes and their development in the movement. The chapter concludes by briefly mentioning Beethoven's Sonatas for Violin, for Cello, and for other instruments, with minimal intra-piece analysis, highlighting d'Indy's primary focus on Beethoven's piano sonatas.

2.4 Terminology for groupings of different structural levels

In d'Indy's chapter, some terms are defined in relation to each other, suggesting that some of them constitute a hierarchical structure. As a general guideline, a musical idea is equivalent to a theme, as seen in the main theme and subordinate themes, and is composed of phrases. Phrases are further broken down into periods, each of which is made up of cells, also referred to as germs or monads.[3]

[2] This temporal division was first proposed by Wilhelm von Lenz [Lenz, 1909] and is still in use today, although the exact divisions may vary slightly. For example, Maynard Solomon categorizes Beethoven's compositions into four main periods: "Bonn," "Vienna: Early Years," "The Heroic Period," and "The Final Phase" [Solomon, 1998].

[3] However, there are instances where this hierarchical structure does not hold, some of which are paradoxically noted by d'Indy himself in his schema, and others that emerge during the analysis, discussed later in this study.

Figure 2.1: "Hammerklavier", mov. 1., *Seconde idée*, first phrase b’, mm. 63-74 [d’Indy, 1909, p. 269].

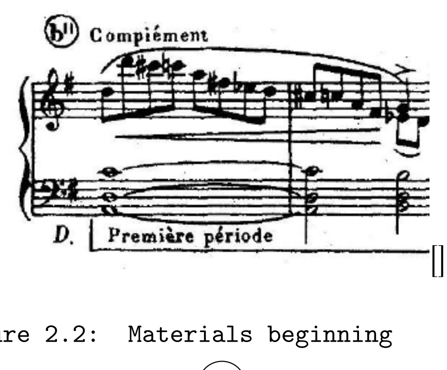

Figure 2.2: Materials beginning the second phrase b’’, mm. 75-99 [d’Indy, 1909, p. 270].

Figure 2.3: Materials beginning the third phrase b’’’, mm. 100-123 [d’Indy, 1909, p. 271].

In his provided and clearly informed analyses, the *Seconde idée* of the first movement of "Hammerklavier" could be considered as a standard example encompassing all four levels of structural units to be discussed in this section: cell, period, phrase, and musical idea [d'Indy, 1909, pp. 268-73]. He identifies measures 64-126 as representing the *Seconde idée*, labeled as "B" (therefore the Subordinate Theme, presented in the Subordinate key, here, G major), in contrast to the *Première idée*, marked "A" (or Main Theme), from earlier in the movement.

In musical idea B, three phrases are found, labeled as b', b'', and b''', in measures 63-74, 75-99, 100-123 respectively. This illustrates a typical structural feature of Beethoven's sonata movements, as d'Indy observes through a formal labeling of all 32 sonatas, where, with a few exceptions, the *Seconde idée* consistently contains three phrases in a sonata movement [d'Indy, 1909, pp. 327-69].

Further, he subdivides the first phrase into three periods: *Première Periode*, *Seconde Periode*, and *Troisième Periode*, in measures 63-66, 67-70 and 71-74 respectively, as shown in Fig. 2.1.

D'Indy notes that the *Première Periode* itself is composed of two clearly defined cells, labeled a'' and b', as shown in the first system of Fig. 2.1.

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After briefly outlining the theme to locate its elements, we will now proceed to define each part in detail, examining the structure step by step from smaller units to larger ones, following d'Indy's order of *Musical Idea Genesis*, where small units generate larger units:

> Logically, it is the motif that should generate the theme, or, to use the terminology previously adopted, it is the cell that generates the period [...] The function of this period is indeed to generate the phrase [...] [d'Indy, 1909, p.239, *translation mine*]

As a result, *genesis*, according to d'Indy, can be understood as a process where lower-level sub-units combine to form larger structures. This hierarchy of generation, moving from the motif to the period and beyond, reveals d'Indy's attempt to establish a systematic approach that ties musical form to the growth of its smallest components.

2.4.1 Cell

A cell (cellule), also referred to as a "germ" (Germe) or "monade," is an indivisible element in the musical hierarchy [d'Indy, 1909, p. 234]. Although a cell and a motif are not identical for d'Indy, a cell aligns with a motif; in other words, the cell serves as the container, while the motif is the content within that container. D'Indy writes,

> Just as the living cell contains the germ, so the musical cell contains, in a way, the motif. In both cases, the container is indissolubly linked to the content: neither can be conceived of separately. There cannot be a cell without a motif, musically speaking, and the decomposition of either, or even their separation under the pretext of analysis, would rightly appear unintelligible, if not unintelligent. [d'Indy, 1909, p.234, *translation mine*]

Cells can be categorized as rhythmic, melodic, or harmonic, with each type being dominated by its respective aspect: rhythm, melody, or harmony. It is important to note, however, that this classification does not exclude other qualities. For instance, a melodic cell is predominantly melodic in nature, but it can also exhibit minimal rhythmic or harmonic dimensions. For example, in Beethoven's "Hammerklavier" shown in Fig. 2.4, the first two cells are identified as rhythmic, while the last is classified as melodic, despite their shared solid-chord texture, which will be further dissected later. Thus, this taxonomy emerges from an adequate generalization—helpful for identifying primary characteristics, but not rigidly definitive.

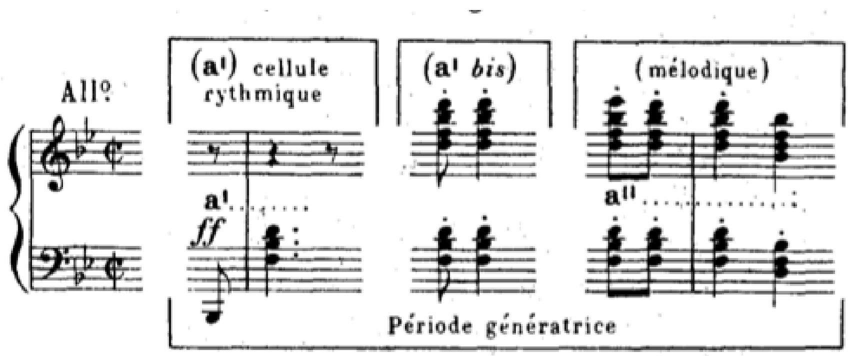

Figure 2.4: Rhythmic and Melodic Cells found in Beethoven's "Hammerklavier" [d'Indy, 1909, p. 236].

Rhythmic Cell The opening two measures of Beethoven's 5th Symphony, shown in Fig. 2.5, exemplify rhythmic cells, where the motive consists of a eigh-note rest, 3 eight-notes followed by a longer note, displaying pronounced rhythmic characteristics.

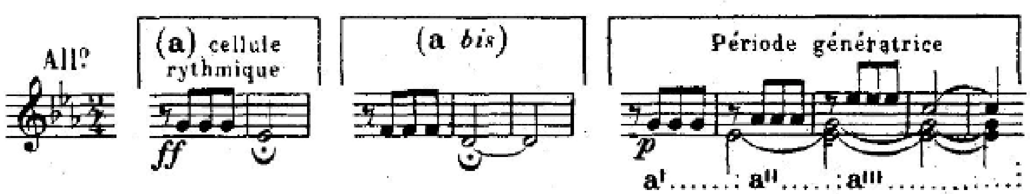

Figure 2.5: mm. 1-5, a rhythmic cell with its repetition, followed by a generative period [d'Indy, 1909, p. 236].

Pitch-wise, this motive consists of only two tones that leap to a third, resulting in a diminished melodic character and insufficient tones to clearly define a harmony, which highlights the rhythmic characteristics even more prominently. As a result, downplaying the role of the other two dimensions further emphasizes the primary rhythmic aspect.

Another example of a rhythmic cell builds on the earlier discussion of the "Hammerklavier" example shown in Fig. 2.4, where the motif is an anacrustic gesture: an eighth note on the weak part of a weak beat, followed by a longer note on a strong beat. Pitch-wise, a significant leap creates a non-cantabile thus non-melodic quality. Additionally, the cell itself does not fully represent the harmonic region it belongs to, as the harmony is articulated over the span of the two measures, rather than by this cell alone, thus also suggesting a minimal harmonic characteristic.

Melodic Cell The third cell of "Hammerklavier" example just discussed is identified as a melodic, in which the upper voice features a descending second, a repeated note and a descending third leap, significantly more cantabile than the previous two cells, displaying a relatively stronger melodic characteristics.

Another example of a melodic cell is found in the beginning of Beethoven's Symphony No. 6, Op. 68, where there are two step-wise motions note pairs (A4-B♭4 and D5-C5), shown in Fig. 2.6. However, these cells do not contain purely linear motion; they include a leap of a third from B♭4 to D5, which still remains cantabile, preventing the cells from becoming scale-like and thus making them more distinctly melodic.

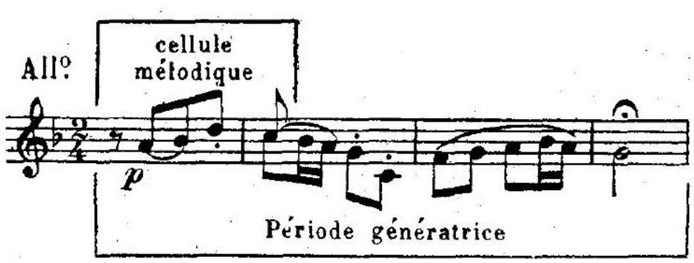

Figure 2.6: Melodic Cell found in Beethoven's Symphony No. 6 [d'Indy, 1909, p. 236].

Harmonic Cell An example of a harmonic cell is found at the beginning of Beethoven's Sonata, Op. 81a "Lebewohl," shown in Fig. 2.7, where the texture consists exclusively of diaphony with a horn-call gesture. [4]

[4]This diaphony mimicks a horn-call gesture by moving from a major 3rd (E♭ to G) to a perfect 5th (D to B♭), defining incomplete I and V chords.

Figure 2.7: Initial Harmonic Cell from Beethoven's Sonata, Op. 81a, No. 1 "Lebewohl" [d'Indy, 1909, p. 237].

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Despite the diaphony suggesting an incomplete harmony for each two-note intervallic structure, it implies an I-V-I progression, with the middle note interpreted as a passing harmony. As a result, this complete cell can be viewed as a prolongation of the tonic harmony. Furthermore, the bass line arpeggiates all the chord tones of the tonic chord, further insinuating an overall tonic harmony. The even duration of each note, unlike the short-long alternation seen in previous examples, combined with the purely stepwise motion in the upper voice, minimizes both the melodic and rhythmic dimensions. As a result, this cell exhibits a strong harmonic character.

❄

However, d'Indy offered an alternative labeling for that cell in a different context. For instance, in the "Histoire" section, d'Indy referred back to this cell as "cellule x" and paired it with a neighboring rhythmic cell, "cellule y" [d'Indy, 1909, p. 255]. In this analysis, he identified "cellule x" specifically as a melodic cell, noting that it generates the second idea (B) of the movement and plays a significant role in the terminal development of the section. Meanwhile, he labeled "cellule y" as a rhythmic cell that gives rise to the first idea (A).

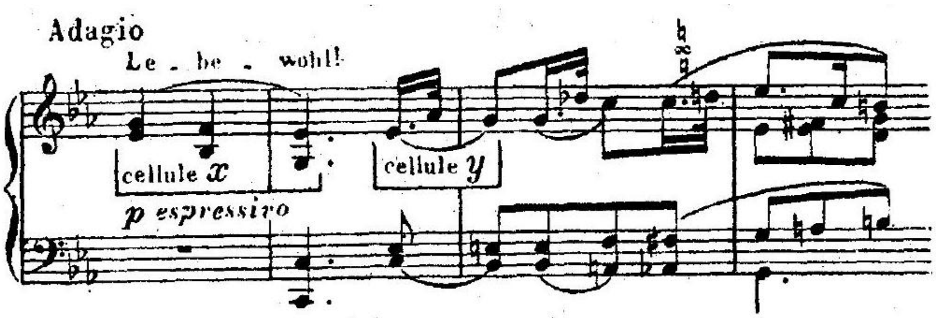

Figure 2.8: Beethoven's Sonata, op. 8, No. 1 "Lebewohl", mov. 1, mm. 1-4 [d'Indy, 1909, p. 255].

This distinction highlights d'Indy's view that cells can take on different roles, melodic or rhythmic, depending on their thematic function within the piece. On one hand, we can speculate that a cell could be categorized based on its behavior in the work. On the other hand, d'Indy demonstrates a degree of inconsistency that may seem excessive; for instance, Campos criticized d'Indy's emphasis on inter-cellular relationship as exaggerated [Campos, 2013, pp. 79-84].

Figure 2.9: Beethoven's Sonata, op. 8, No. 1 "Lebewohl", mov. 1, mm. 50-2 [d'Indy, 1909, p. 255].

Shown in Fig. 2.10, d'Indy observes that cells x and y, initially identified in the introduction of Beethoven's sonata, reappear here in a structured and purposeful way. He views cell x as a skeleton—a fundamental descending line that provides structural grounding. Along this skeleton, the rhythmic cell y appears three times, creating a recurring pattern that follows the descending trajectory established by cell x.

Campos points out that labeling the passage in Fig. 2.10 as containing 3 reoccurrences of cell y raises difficulties, as it is unclear whether its identity is defined primarily by its initial rhythm (♪♬♪), its interval pattern, or its accentuation. He suggests that the size of this combination is insufficient to establish meaningful thematic connections.

Figure 2.10: Beethoven's Sonata, op. 8, No. 1 "Lebewohl", mov. 1, mm. 16-20 [d'Indy, 1909, p. 256].

However, while this claim may seem exaggerated, d'Indy's analysis consistently centers around this concept and applies it repeatedly. As we will see later in his analysis of the Hammerklavier, d'Indy links different formal sections within a single movement through the recurrence of motifs contained within cells. Furthermore, this approach to motivic connection extends beyond individual movements, as seen in Example 2.11, where cells x and y are identified in the Finale movement. This inter-movement association lays the groundwork for d'Indy's discussion of cyclic sonata in his subsequent chapter.[5]

[5]In Chapter 5 of Volume 2 - Part 1, d'Indy describes the cyclic sonata as a form in which the construction is unified by recurring thematic material, which reappears in various forms across each movement and serves a regulatory or unifying function. This cyclic quality, created by the presence of recurring themes or "motifs conducteurs," lends each movement a sense of interdependence within the larger work. While cyclic elements are not exclusive to the sonata, d'Indy considers the sonata to be the prototype for all symphonic forms that later adopted cyclic structure. He credits Beethoven with pioneering this approach, which was fully realized by César Franck [d'Indy, 1909,

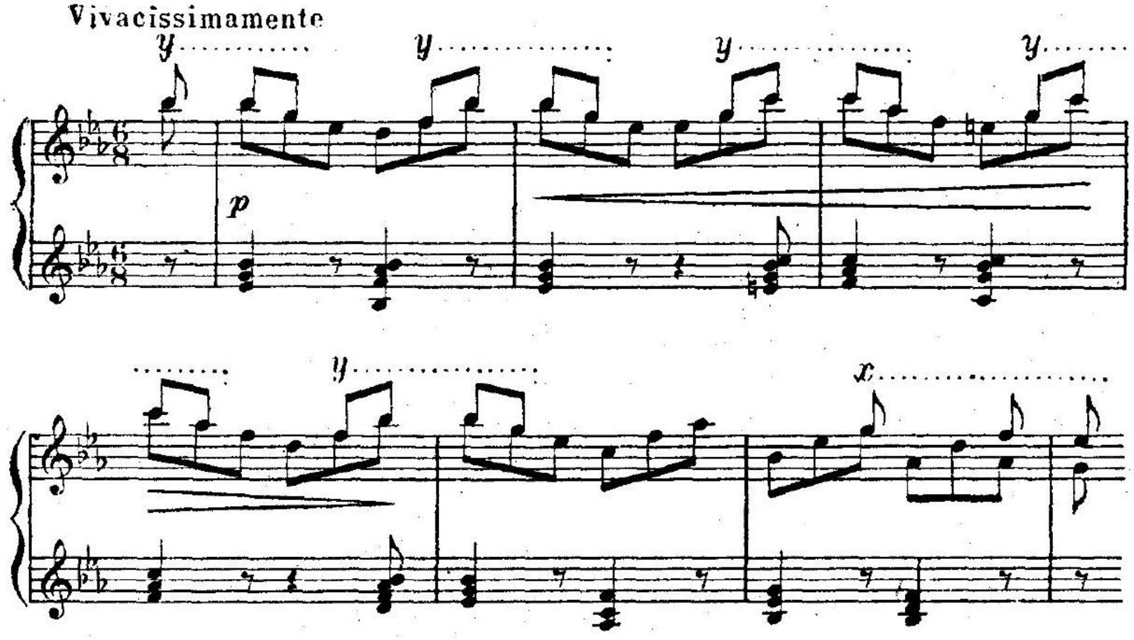

Figure 2.11: Beethoven's Sonata, op. 8, No. 1 "Lebewohl", mov. 3, mm. 10-6 [d'Indy, 1909, p. 256].

2.4.2 Period

A period, as a structural unit in d'Indy's discourse, located in between the cells and the musical ideas (themes), typically consists of a combination of multiple cells. It often receives an ordinal attribute based on its position within a larger structural unit[6], resulting in labels such as the initial period, secondary period, and third period. The most commonly referenced type of period is the initial period, also known as the principal period, but it is most frequently referred to as the generative period [d'Indy, 1909, pp. 234-5].

Like a cell, the term period refers to a grouping entity, with each period containing specific thematic or motivic content within its boundaries. This container-content relationship applies to all periods in general. However, the generative period holds a unique role: it introduces the fundamental thematic cells, with subsequent

p. 375].

[6]Such larger structural unit could be either a musical idea or a phrase, which will be introduced while discussing *Phrase* as a structural unit in d'Indy's discourse.

periods drawing on this generative theme rather than introducing entirely new motives. This relationship is the basis for d'Indy's designation of this initial period as the generative period, as it serves as the source from which the thematic content of later periods is derived, or "generated". In this way, the generative period serves as a template, establishing the primary theme that subsequent periods develop rather than introducing new motives.

The distinction between cells and periods is based on different criteria: cells are defined by the number of notes they contain, while periods are defined by the number of measures they span. A cell typically consists of a small set of notes, as it cannot be meaningfully divided beyond its constituent pitches. In contrast, a period must extend for at least two measures, as shown in Examples 2.5 and 2.4, highlighting that its length is determined by its measure count rather than the number of individual notes. Thus, the structure of a cell is constrained by its note content, while the structure of a period is determined by its rhythmic span.

Generative Period A generative period is a specific subclass of a period, as discussed above, and coincides with a generative theme. In this relationship, the same container-content analogy applies: the generative period serves as the container, while the generative theme represents the content within the region bounded by this period, as stated by d'Indy,

> This principal period contains the generating theme, just as the cell contains the motif. Here again, the container is necessarily linked to the content: there is no principal period without a generating theme. [d'Indy, 1909, p.235, *translation mine*]

Although both terms—generative period and generative theme—describe different entities, they are intertwined within the same temporal span. However, the word "generative," which is etymologically linked to *genesis*, is more prominently associated with the period level than with other entities throughout the text, raising the question of why d'Indy privileges this term. D'Indy himself offers some insight:

> Logically, it is the motif that should generate the theme, or, using the terminology we previously adopted, it is the cell that generates the period; but this latent process occurs **unconsciously** in most cases, which is why we call it the generating period when it generally presents itself to the composer's mind as a whole, rather than through successive fragments, except when it later undergoes profound voluntary and conscious modifications.
>
> The function of this period is, in fact, to generate the phrase, or phrases, that express the idea; and this second operation is never the result of chance, pure instinct, or what is commonly referred to as 'inspiration.' [d'Indy, 1909, p.239, *translation mine*]

Thus, d'Indy seems to privilege the term generative period because he believes that it is at this level that the composer becomes consciously aware of the material. This level marks the transition from unconscious development to deliberate compositional control, as the composer begins to organize the musical material with clear intent. The generative period, therefore, represents a turning point where creative processes become consciously directed and purposeful, explaining why d'Indy emphasizes it over other subunits.

This perspective is exemplified in his analysis of Example 2.12, where he states,

> The initial cell (a') is predominantly rhythmic and tonal: it acts upon the generating period, stated twice on two different degrees, and gives this first idea a primarily masculine character.
>
> The eighth-note pattern (a''), however, takes on a more melodic aspect in the secondary or complementary periods. This contrast does not undermine the stylistic unity of the idea, as this pattern (a''), common to all the periods, establishes a real connection between them. [d'Indy, 1909, p.264, *translation mine*]

a'' seems to keep a rhythmic dimension in addition to its melodic identity. As a

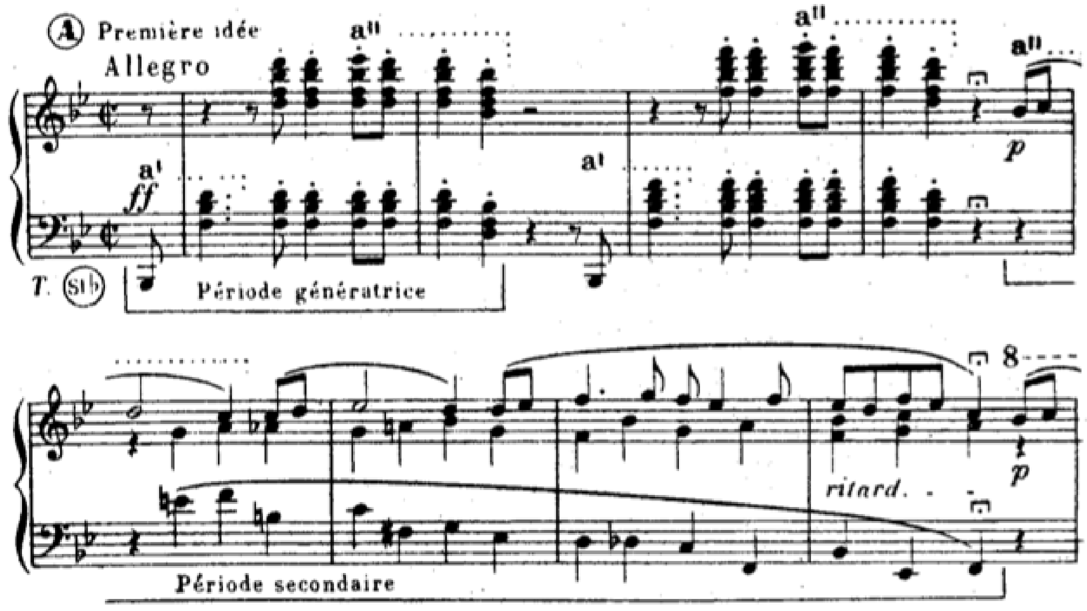

Figure 2.12: D'Indy's analysis on the opening measures [d'Indy, 1909, p. 264].

result, d'Indy views the beginning of the second period's material as originating from the a'' melodic cell, albeit with some modifications: a shift from staccato to legato, slight alterations at the start of the melodic line, yet maintaining the descending contour in the last two notes. This ending gesture reinforces the resemblance, even though the third note is elongated to a half-note, subtly preserving the underlying connection to the generative period despite the surface-level changes.

Upon investigating the generative period, the role of cells seems to come to the forefront. On one hand, d'Indy believes that at the cellular level, much of the composer's creative activity is guided by an instinctual, unconscious force. On the other hand, without subdividing periods into smaller cells, the connection between different sections might not be readily apparent—especially through a visual reading of the score rather than an aural experience. This subdivision helps to highlight how seemingly unrelated material can be traced back to earlier sections, as otherwise, such associations could remain obscured by surface-level elements, like dense chords written in succession. Therefore, breaking the music down into cells serves an analytical purpose: to reveal and articulate relationships that might remain acoustically implicit, ensuring that connections between sections are made more explicit and justifiable from a theoretical standpoint.

2.4.3 Phrase

D'Indy provided an explicit definition of a phrase in relation to a period: a phrase is formed by the sequential arrangement of the main or generative period followed by the secondary periods, which together articulate a larger structural unit such as a musical idea or the transition. As seen in Example 2.1, this phrase consists of three periods.

However, d'Indy's assertion of "Phrase" in relation to musical idea is somewhat contradictory, as he provides two different perspectives in the same discussion. Initially, he states that a phrase encapsulates a musical idea, similar to how a principal period contains a generative theme, or how a cell contains a motif. However, he later notes that a musical idea might require multiple phrases for its complete expression, with one phrase serving as the principal one that holds the essential part of the idea. This suggests that, while a phrase can be seen as a container for an idea, a single idea may also span several phrases, thereby challenging the clarity of his terminology. D'Indy mentions,

> The phrase contains the idea, just as the main period contains the generating theme and the cell contains the motif; however, although the motif is always entirely included in the cell, and the theme in the period, the musical idea is not necessarily stated by a single phrase. The full expression of the idea sometimes requires, on the contrary, two and even three phrases, one of which, the main one, contains the essential part of the idea. [d'Indy, 1909, p.235, *translation mine*]

Thus, d'Indy initially asserts that a phrase contains a musical idea, similar to how a motif is contained within a cell. But by acknowledging that a musical idea may require more than one phrase for its full expression, d'Indy creates a paradox within his own definitions—a contradiction that I will attempt to clarify after examining his concept of the musical idea.

2.4.4 Musical Idea

Musical Idea: Generalized vs. Constrained To resolve the ambiguity and avoid confusion, I propose a distinction between a generalized musical idea and a constrained musical idea, as illustrated in Table 2.5. A **Constrained Musical Idea** refers to the specific content of a single phrase container, which includes significant thematic material, typically aligning with the generative theme. On the other hand, a **Generalized Musical Idea** represents a broader formal section, equivalent to a musical theme, such as a primary theme or a subordinate theme in Caplinian sense. This ambiguity could be an example of phenomenon called "pars pro toto," meaning "a part (taken) for the whole," where a smaller component is often used to designate a larger structure containing it [Oxford Living Dictionaries, 2016].

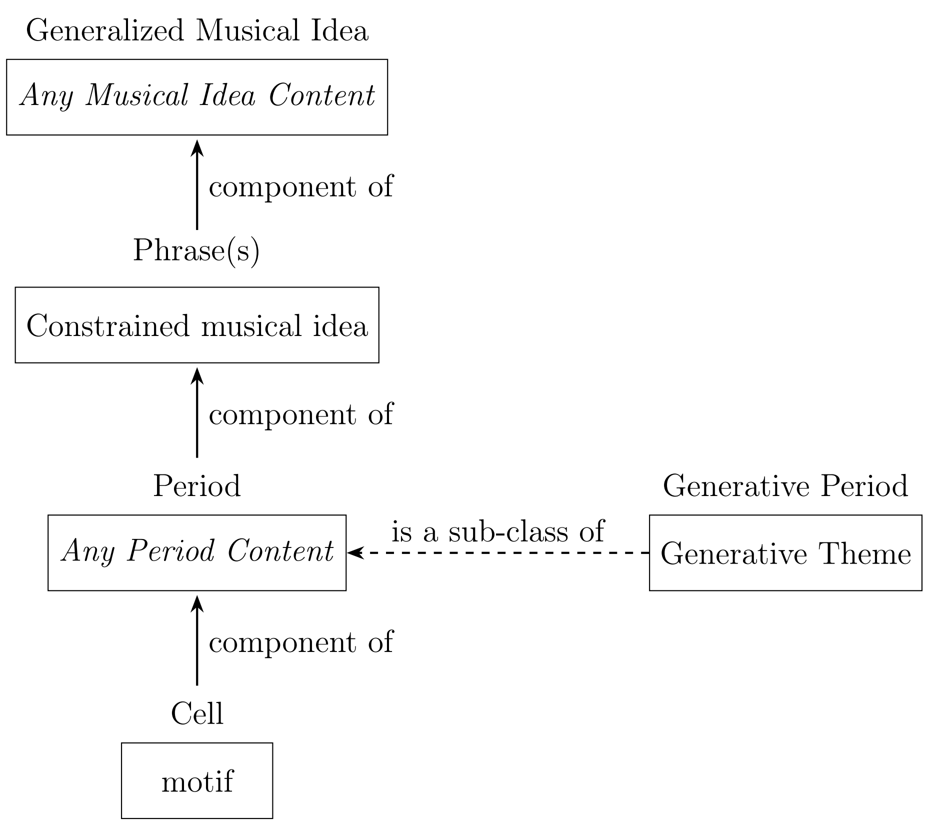

Table 2.5: An Illustration of Hierarchy of Terminologies as a rule of thumb

Therefore, d'Indy equates a single phrase with a single theme, and a group of multiple phrases with a theme group. Examples 2.1, 2.2, and 2.3, each corresponding to a phrase, collectively form a Generalized Musical Idea. Among the phrases in this theme group, however, the first phrase in Example 2.1 is the most thematic and prominent, thus corresponding to a Constrained Musical Idea.

Genesis vs. Development of Musical Idea Genesis refers to the process of forming a musical idea, completing the initial phase during which the idea does not yet exist in its full form. Therefore, activities of genesis can be observed at formal levels below a thematic unit, such as a generative period. If the musical idea has not yet been fully established, then while materials, such as motivic elements, may appear to "develop," they still fall within the scope of genesis.

Development, on the other hand, is a technique that involves expanding and elaborating on an already established musical idea. Development extends the original idea and transforms it through variation, transposition, integration within new keys, and other techniques, allowing the idea to evolve within the musical structure and create a sense of direction and effects of surprise and reorientation.

The development technique typically occurs in two scenarios: first, after the exposition ended where both musical ideas have been introduced, such as in the development section; second, when only the primary idea has been stated, with development techniques leading into the rest, as seen in moments where materials from the first idea reappear in the transition and the second idea. Compared to the some discussion of genesis, this study barely covers development techniques, as neither of the two typical scenarios for development falls within its scope.

This study's discussion is confined to the exposition and does not extend beyond it. Consequently, the first scenario falls outside the scope of this analysis.[7]

For the other scenario, since the structural architecture above the level of the musical idea remains consistent across various theories—including d'Indy's—as nearly

[7] The development section is a formal section with less conventionality, making it less adequate to generalize than other sections. Furthermore, d'Indy's analysis of the development section is illustrated by the Hammerklavier Sonata, where the development consists largely of a fugal passage. This approach is unconventional and not fully representative of Beethoven's typical sonata developments, making it less suitable for comparative purposes in this study.

all sonata theories feature a main theme, transition, and subordinate theme in the exposition, followed by the development and recapitulation sections, reporting on d'Indy's discussion about these structural elements offers limited new insights. There is therefore significantly less discussion of development as a technique compared to that of genesis in this study, as the primary focus of this study is on structures below the level of the musical idea, whereas development as a technique pertains to activities above that level.

2.5 D'Indy's Values

Understanding d'Indy's analytical values requires examining the broader ideological and methodological principles that underpin his approach. His theories reflect a preference for homogeneity and dualistic structures, interpreting musical contrasts through a lens of binary oppositions such as gender and "masculine" vs. "feminine" themes. This tendency extends to his use of numbers and proportional systems, which impose a sense of structural order. However, these values are not purely formalistic—they are intertwined with cultural and ideological beliefs, including his documented views on race and nationalism, which permeate his veneration of certain composers and his hierarchical treatment of musical styles. To contextualize d'Indy's values, it is crucial to compare them with those of other pre-modern theorists, whose frameworks similarly blend musical analysis with broader cultural ideologies. Through this comparison, we can extract representative values that illuminate not just d'Indy's theoretical approach but also the larger cultural narratives that shaped early music theory.

2.5.1 Gendering Themes

Vincent d'Indy's exploration of sonata form places a notable emphasis on the gendering of thematic material, reflecting both the formal principles of the music and the cultural ideologies. He perceives the interaction between the primary and secondary themes not merely as a technical contrast but as a reflection of archetypal gender dynamics. For d'Indy, these themes take on masculine and feminine characteristics, embodying broader narratives of strength, clarity, grace, and fluidity. He writes,

> Strength and energy, conciseness and clarity: these are almost invariably the masculine traits of the first idea: it imposes itself in vigorous and abrupt rhythms, clearly affirming its tonal property, singular and definitive.
>
> The second idea, on the other hand, full of sweetness and melodic grace, almost always displays through its prolixity and modulating indetermination traits that are eminently feminine: supple and elegant, it gradually unfolds the curve of its adorned melody. [d'Indy, 1909, p.262, *translation mine*]

Through this lens, d'Indy not only reinforces the established understanding of thematic contrast but also extends it to an almost symbolic level, where the primary theme's firm tonal grounding and energetic rhythmic structure represent masculine authority. The secondary theme, on the other hand, is imbued with a feminine quality, characterized by its melodic intricacy and harmonic instability.

This gendered symbolism resonates with the earlier ideas of theorists like A.B. Marx. d'Indy posits a duality of male and female principles in music, reflecting a broader cultural tendency to ascribe gender roles to abstract concepts. Marx had previously articulated a similar duality in musical phrases, associating strong, directive gestures with masculinity and more passive, resolving gestures with femininity [Burnham, 1996].

In this sense, d'Indy and Marx are part of the same theoretical lineage that seeks to explain musical drama as the interaction between opposing forces—forces that must ultimately be reconciled in the form's resolution. While the gendered metaphor is a striking aspect of d'Indy's writing, it is only one manifestation of a much larger, more abstract concept of duality that pervades his thinking on music.

2.5.2 Dualism

Marx's application of dualism to various musical elements does not limit to gender analogy, but he also proposed, such as Gang and Satz—terms that describe the forward motion of music (*Gang*) versus its state of rest or closure (*Satz*) [Marx, 1879].

Similarly, d'Indy introduces his own dualistic terminology, referring to the *état de marche* and *état de repos*, also known as *état de translation* and *état d'immobilité* respectively [d'Indy, 1909, pp. 243-4]. The état de marche, akin to Marx's *Gang*, is characterized by a sense of movement, drive, and progression, which we can easily associate with the "masculine" principal theme. The état de repos, much like Marx's *Satz*, is a state of rest or resolution, mirroring the qualities of the "feminine" secondary theme, which is more expansive, lyrical, and modulatory. This structural dualism not only reflects d'Indy's preference for contrasting forces but also reinforces the broader 19th-century intellectual tradition of viewing musical form through the lens of oppositional pairs, whether gendered, dynamic, or harmonic.

2.5.3 Number Favour

Beyond duality, Vincent d'Indy's theoretical favour on the number three as a structural and generative element permeates his music analysis. This manifests in various aspects of his theoretical system, such as the three types of cells and developments (rhythmic, melodic, and harmonic), and the three types of modulation (passing, accidental, definitive). A tripartite structures also surface in his formal subdivision, where in his second book, he often identifies three phrases in the second idea section such that section of "Hammerklavier" discussed earlier, and three periods in a phrase, such as in 2.1. There is therefore a tripartite structure nested inside another tripartite structure.

This numerical emphasis parallels Heinrich Schenker's privileging of the number five, which he views as a synthesizer of musical coherence [Clark, 1999]. As described by Clark, according to Schenker, all musical elements are generated from a single origin through organic replication, and the number five could be traced in various places. Schenker's theory of the fundamental line derives from the notion that the number five is the essential structure underlying all tonal music, a view that contrasts but runs alongside d'Indy's focus on the number three.

Number plays a crucial role in understanding the concept of generation: by using a consistent numerical basis, it ensures internal coherence, uniformity, and a clear hierarchical structure, which collectively form the foundation of organicity. With one consistent rule applied throughout, the structure replicates itself naturally, creating a sense of growth and development akin to an organism expanding according to its inherent logic.

2.5.4 Generation

The concept of generative structures further links d'Indy's theoretical approach to that of Schenker, and the use of number contributes to the process of generation. Prior to both scholars, the idea of generation in music theory was confined primarily to the realm of harmony. Introduced by Rameau, this concept was understood as the generation of chord tones from the *corps sonore* or fundamental tone [Rameau, 1966].

However, Rameau's generative approach relies heavily on assertions, supported only as far as natural phenomena can explain them. Once this explanatory power breaks down—such as in the case of generating a minor chord—his theory collapses. For instance, while the overtone series can justify the generation of a major chord, it cannot logically extend to the minor chord, forcing Rameau to treat it as a mirror image rather than a true product of acoustic laws. To some extent, relationships in generative processes are established through assertions, though they may be supported by analogical or epistemological interpretations. Nevertheless, these interpretations remain secondary, as the primary focus is on maintaining internal consistency.

By the time of d'Indy and Schenker, the notion of generation had expanded beyond harmony to encompass formal structures, with both theorists striving for a more uniform and hierarchical system. Numbers are central to their frameworks, providing a consistent basis for structural organization. Schenker's "five generates all" principle uses the descent from the fifth scale degree to shape the tonal and harmonic framework of an entire composition, suggesting an organic unity throughout. Similarly, d'Indy applies a generative concept using a "three-period phrase" as a foundational building block from which larger forms are constructed. This use of consistent numbers imbues their theories of organic replication or *Genesis of Musical Idea*, reinforcing the perception that each formal unit is a natural outgrowth of its predecessors.

In summary, d'Indy's concept of generation, by referencing theories developed from other theorists, can be understood as the association of formal subunits through a consistent numerical framework. However, the internal content of the generative source also plays a crucial role in shaping the generation process, as later elements are seen as organic replications or "Geniture" of earlier material.[8] For instance, Rameau's generative source, the *corps sonore*, uses frequency as its defining attribute, with numerical ratios establishing harmonic relationships based on that attribute. In contrast, for Schenker and d'Indy, who operate at the level of form, a wider array of attributes is available. Motivic content becomes a key element, prompting them to a strong emphasis on homogeneity in their analyses. This emphasis further supports their view that subsequent materials are logical extensions or transformations of a primary generative source, reinforcing the perception of organic development throughout the musical structure.

Generative theory of tonal music Later scholars Fred Lerdahl and Ray Jackendoff introduced the Generative Theory of Tonal Music (GTTM) [Lerdahl and Jackendoff, 1983], which bears a terminological resemblance to d'Indy's concept of generation. GTTM, derived from Chomsky's generative grammar, is structured as a recursive, tree-like model that proceeds from top to bottom, breaking down music into hierarchical lay-

[8] "Geniture" is referring the result of a *Genesis*.

ers. GTTM comprises four primary structures: Grouping Structure, Metrical Structure, Time-span Reduction, and Prolongational Reduction. Of these, Time-Span Reduction focuses on local harmonic relationships, closure, and cadential points within smaller segments, while Prolongational Reduction addresses global harmonic continuity, organizing the music's overarching tonal direction and stability.

In d'Indy's analysis of Beethoven, Metrical Structure—the systematic layering of strong and weak beats—is not a primary focus. Instead, his emphasis is on the grouping and development of thematic and motivic elements, aligning more closely with GTTM's Grouping Structure. In his framework, individual cells are grouped together to form periods, multiple periods are grouped into phrases, and multiple phrases combine into larger sections such as musical ideas.

While both d'Indy and GTTM use the term generation, they apply this term to designate different processes. For d'Indy, generation means building from the atomic level, where fundamental units or cells progressively group together into periods, phrases, and eventually larger formal structures. In contrast, GTTM understands generation as a deductive, grammar-like process, where overarching structural principles generate the finer details of the music, guiding each level of hierarchy from the top down.

Though both approaches use the term "generation" and applied it at the formal level—unlike Rameau's use of similar terminology applied in harmonic level—d'Indy's method remains fundamentally distinct and original, by constructing form by aggregating small units, whereas GTTM derives detail from broad structural rules. Upon noting the terminological resemblance between d'Indy's concept of generation and that of others, it becomes clear that his application of the term is quite remarkable and distinct from similar theoretical uses.

2.5.5 Homogeneity, Parallelism and Motivic Coherence

The dualistic mindset of d'Indy also leads d'Indy to emphasize homogeneity within each side of the binary opposition. Furthermore, his tendency to work with a tripartite structure leads him to cluster materials based on shared characteristics. As a result, materials with a common texture tend to be grouped together as part of the same category, reinforcing internal cohesion within each side of the binary opposition. This approach aligns with the parallelism principle of GTTM discussed above, where similar patterns are grouped together to create perceptual coherence. This emphasis on uniformity can sometimes lead to interpretative issues, particularly when it causes him to overlook conventional formal boundaries. A striking example of this occurs in his analysis of the first movement of Beethoven's Moonlight Sonata. Rather than treating it as a sonata-form movement, d'Indy labels it as a "Lent" type piece [d'Indy, 1909, pp. 343].

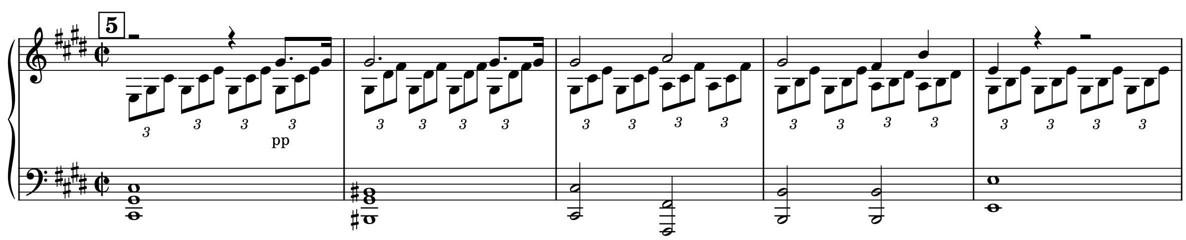

Figure 2.13: "Moonlight" Mov. 1, Main Theme.

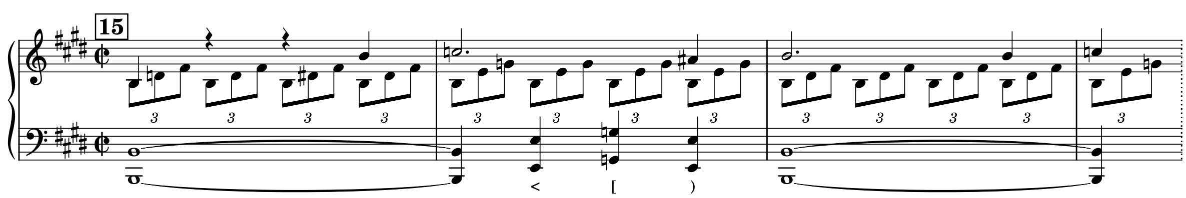

Figure 2.14: "Moonlight" Mov. 1, Second Theme.

The movement's uniform triplet texture, which remains prominent throughout, may obscure its formal sections, leading d'Indy to prioritize its surface homogeneity over its structural logic. This unconventional approach complicates comparative analysis, as his labels diverge from contemporary formal interpretations, thereby creating discrepancies in understanding the movement's structure. This tension between duality and homogeneity in d'Indy's analytical method becomes a key factor in the contrasting formal interpretations explored in subsequent chapters.

Besides, Schenker also values homogeneity, as his idea of the *Linkage technique*, which he introduced in his analysis of Brahms's "Variations and Fugue on a Theme by Handel, op. 24," from "Der Tonwille 8/9" ([1924]), is essentially about associating materials that are homogeneous [Baker, 2020, p. 101]. This technique emphasizes the repetition and imitation of motives, incorporating variations and contrasts rather than exact duplications.

At its core, the *Linkage technique* enhances the music's internal coherence and integrity by connecting melodic, harmonic, and rhythmic elements. This approach transcends simple thematic repetition by showcasing the extension and transformation of motives across different dimensions, thus revealing deeper structural relationships beneath the surface of the music.

2.5.6 Racism

Generalization is often necessary when constructing theoretical frameworks, as it helps simplify complex ideas into manageable categories. Favoring certain choices—such as number—stands out because of its quantifiable nature, lending itself to clear, directly measurable distinctions that can structure abstract concepts more concretely.

However, generalization can easily slip into stereotypical or reductive thinking. An overreliance on drawing parallels to nature, or claiming "natural laws" as justifications, often leads to oversimplification and a stereotyped worldview. This is particularly problematic when applied beyond music theory, as seen in the dangerous applications of social Darwinism. D'Indy and Schenker, both known for their organicist approaches to form analysis, are prone to similar pitfalls when they impose analogies from natural phenomena onto their theoretical models, risking a reductionist perspective that echoes these broader misapplications.

Both d'Indy and Schenker entwine their music theories with overt ideological positions, particularly nationalism and racism. D'Indy's antisemitic views documented by [Pasler, 2007] and [de Médicis, 2024], is his veneration of Beethoven as a symbol of musical and cultural purity. Like d'Indy, Schenker favored German composers, elevating their works as exemplars of his theoretical system. However, he makes an exception for Frédéric Chopin, whom he refers to as an "honorary German," acknowledging Chopin's genius but placing it within a framework that reinforces the superiority of Germanic musical traditions. Schenker's similar nationalistic leanings align with his ideological belief in the supremacy of German music, particularly that of the Austro-German tradition, while dismissing non-Germanic influences. Both theorists construct their music theories to support these broader ideological views, intertwining their aesthetic judgments with cultural and racial biases.

2.6 Conclusion

In conclusion, d'Indy's approach aligns with earlier stylistic conventions that contemporary perspectives now challenge. Taking his example of gendering themes, today's understanding of gender and identity rejects the strict binary model he employs. The notion that contrasting musical forces must inherently embody "masculine" or "feminine" traits is now seen as overly simplistic and reductive. Modern perspectives emphasize that identity and expression exist on a spectrum, moving beyond a rigid "either/or" framework toward a more inclusive view that allows for "both/and" or even non-binary interpretations. This shift challenges the very premise of d'Indy's gendered oppositions, highlighting that his approach is not just outdated but also deeply rooted in cultural biases that shaped the broader ideological narratives of his time.

In contrast, contemporary theories, such as William Caplin's theory of formal functions, are largely free of overt ideological biases. Caplin acknowledges the historical use of gendered themes by theorists like A.B. Marx in his textbook, noting it as a historical fact but refraining from incorporating it into his own theoretical framework [Caplin, 2013, p. 358]. Caplin's approach is more concerned with providing a neutral, systematic analysis of musical form, emphasizing practical and structural observations without layering them with cultural or ideological interpretations. His work engages with music on its own terms, offering clear examples and analytical categories that prioritize the internal logic of the music over symbolic narratives.

Comparing d'Indy's theory with Caplin's is valuable because it underscores a fundamental shift in music theory: from interpretive models laden with ideological assumptions to frameworks that aim for a more objective, context-independent analysis. This contrast not only reveals the biases in earlier theories but also illustrates how contemporary theory seeks to disentangle analytical methods from subjective or culturally contingent narratives. Understanding these differences is crucial in evaluating how music theories have evolved and the ways in which modern methodologies strive for analytical clarity and inclusivity.

2.7 Caplinian Theory Overview

This study presumes a certain level of familiarity with Caplinian analysis, as it is widely recognized within the field of music theory.

William Caplin first introduced the concept of "Expanded Cadential Progressions" in his 1987 article [Caplin, 1987]. He expanded on these ideas in his 1998 textbook, *Classical Form: A Theory of Formal Functions for the Instrumental Music of Haydn, Mozart, and Beethoven* [Caplin, 1998]. In his 2000 article, "Harmonic Variants of the 'Expanded Cadential Progression,'" Caplin refined his earlier concept by proposing that certain harmonies within these cadences could be substituted with chromatically altered chords [Caplin, 2000]. His 2004 article, "The Classical Cadence: Conceptions and Misconceptions," reaffirmed his views on cadences, highlighting the differences between his approach and traditional harmonic theory, and offering insights into common misunderstandings about cadences [Caplin, 2004]. Caplin further developed these ideas in his 2013 textbook, *Analyzing Classical Form: An Approach for the Classroom* [Caplin, 2013], and in his 2018 article, "Beyond the Classical Cadence: Thematic Closure in Early Romantic Music," where he applied his theoretical concepts to the analysis of Romantic-era compositions [Caplin, 2018].

Caplin's most significant theoretical contribution is his framework of formal functions, which categorizes a musical work or section into distinct stages such as beginning, middle, and ending, with these stages represented through harmonic progressions identified as "prolongational," "sequential," or "cadential," respectively [Caplin, 2013, p. 35]. This approach applies to larger structures like the exposition, development, and recapitulation, as well as smaller intra-thematic structures, such as the presentation, continuation, and cadential phrases in a sentence theme type. Furthermore, Caplin's theory examines whether a section is "tight-knit" or "loose" in terms of its phrase-structural organization, noting that a sentence is a looser theme type compared to a period theme type [Caplin, 2013, p. 203-4].

Caplin's explainsthe "sentence" theme type as a conventional yet looser theme structure within classical composition. The sentence begins with a presentation phase that typically prolongs the tonic harmony, setting a stable foundation. This is followed by a continuation phase, which may use one or several of various techniques such as fragmentation and an acceleration of both surface and harmonic rhythm, marking a clear middle section that often includes sequential progressions. The end of the sentence is articulated by a cadential idea in a cadential phase, which is syntactical and signifies a conclusive end to the thematic unit. This structure allows Caplin to demonstrate how thematic development and formal functions interact within the broader context of classical music's phrase structure.

Caplin's explains the "period" theme type as a tight-knit and more balanced structure compared to the sentence [Caplin, 2013, p. 203-4]. A period consists of two main phrases: the antecedent and the consequent, each typically spanning four measures, contributing to its symmetrical form. The antecedent phrase ends with a weaker cadence—most often a half cadence or an imperfect authentic cadence—creating a sense of incompleteness that prompts a continuation. This cadence establishes a point of tension or pause, setting up the expectation for a stronger resolution. The consequent phrase then mirrors the antecedent's basic melodic material, but with variations that lead to a more conclusive cadence, typically an authentic cadence [Caplin, 2013, p. 73-85]. This closing cadence provides a symmetry to the period and syntactical closure, effectively reinforcing the tonal goal and unifying the phrase structure.

It is essential to acknowledge that Caplin's theory, as a contemporary analytical framework, does not exist in isolation. It frequently incorporates and references other theoretical frameworks, including ideas from Schmalfeldt, Hepokoski, and Darcy. For example, in *Analyzing Classical Form*, terms such as "One More Time" and "Medial Caesura" are integrated into the analysis, highlighting the dialogue between Caplin's ideas and existing theories [Caplin, 2013, pp. 143, 310].

Moreover, Caplin's theory is so influential that many scholars have created their own versions based on his ideas. These variants, that I will refer later in the text as "Neo-Caplinian," share a common theoretical ground. They build around Caplin's concepts and terminology, meaning they are part of the same analytical discourse, even if each scholar brings their own perspective.

Therefore, it is more accurate to describe the upcoming analysis not as a confrontation of Caplin's and d'Indy's theory, but rather of contemporary theory and those articulated by d'Indy's, whose ideas also resonate with the broader theoretical landscape of his time, as evidenced by the resemblances identified earlier. Therefore, the interaction between d'Indy's and Caplin's theories can be seen as a dialogue between two epochs. Such a comparative analysis could yield valuable insights that contribute significantly to the field of *New Formenlehre*.

Part II

Analysis

Chapter 3

On Symphony No. 5, Op. 67, Movement 1

3.1 Introduction

This chapter transitions into a comparative analysis between d'Indy's and Caplin's approaches, using Beethoven's Symphony No. 5, Op. 67, Movement 1 as a case study. The movement, despite its revolutionary thematic development and structural innovations, adheres to a relatively textbook-friendly sonata form, making it an ideal foundation for exploring the theoretical differences between the two scholars. Both d'Indy and Caplin have engaged with this movement in their writings, treating some of its passages as ~~an~~ exemplary cases to illustrate Beethoven's compositional techniques. However, their analyses show significant discrepancies, particularly in defining formal boundaries and interpreting the roles of certain thematic materials, which underscores their distinct analytical priorities and methodologies.

D'Indy's theoretical perspective offers a unique lens for examining the movement, but it introduces some limitations in labeling specific sections, such as the transition. Conversely, Caplin's formal-functional theory appears to provide a clearer outline at background level. However, while his theory aims to categorize each section's function systematically, it encounters inconsistencies when applied to certain passages—in this movement, specifically, there is ambiguity regarding where the main theme actually begins, blurring the distinction between the thematic introduction and the main theme itself.

By comparing these conflicting interpretations, this chapter aims to expand on the contrasting assumptions and criteria that underlie each theorist's framework and how these differences impact our understanding of Beethoven's work. For d'Indy, his theory of genesis offers more internal consistency over Caplin's functional framework when dealing with formal ambiguity. However, as previously identified, his emphasis on homogeneity and motivic coherence can also introduce new issues, leading to interpretations that omits formal functions and blur distinct formal boundaries.

3.2 On the main theme

3.2.1 Vincent d'Indy's Analysis

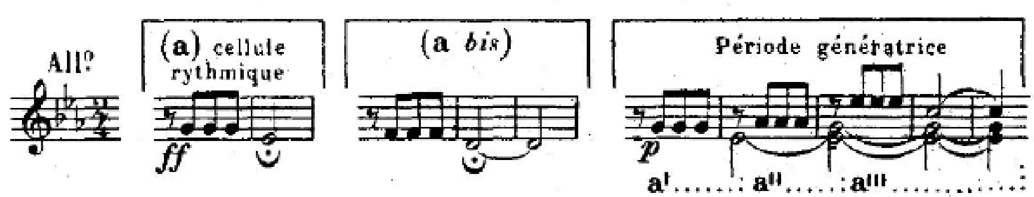

Figure 3.1: mm. 1-5 treated as two rhythmic cells, followed by a generative period [d'Indy, 1909, p. 236].

D'Indy included an analysis of the first eight measures in both the "Beethovenian Sonata" chapter [d'Indy, 1909, p.236] and a concise form labeling in the "Symphony" chapter [d'Indy, 1933, pp. 129-30]. His inclusion of this example in the former chapter suggests that d'Indy's analytical approach presented there can equally apply to Beethoven's symphonic works, even though terms are sometimes used interchangeably. For instance, what is referred to as a "musical idea" in the sonata context is termed a "symphonic theme" in the symphonic chapter.

Shown in Fig. 3.1, d'Indy treats mm. 6-9 as a generative period and the opening measures as rhythmic cells that, normally being part of that generative period, is stated separately and beforehand. He says,

> The 5th Symphony, op. 67, also begins with a generating period of a rhythmic nature; however, the cell, instead of being part of the period as in op. 106, is stated separately and beforehand, on two different occasions. [d'Indy, 1909, p. 236, *translation mine*]

This suggests some variation of the hierarchical structure introduced earlier. Furthermore, in the "Symphony" chapter, d'Indy refers to these four measures as an introduction [d'Indy, 1933, p. 129][1], noting that two rhythmic cells, which would typically belong to the generative period, are instead used to introduce it, being removed from their usual structural container.

Recalling the definition of a period, it is supposed to function as a container that encapsulates the generative theme. However, in this instance, d'Indy shifts the period's starting point five measures later, omitting the introductory measures from the container altogether. This decision is partially due to the thin texture of the opening. The introductory section lacks the structural and thematic weight characteristic of a complete period.

There is a notable texture shift at m. 6. Prior to this, the music is presented in tutti unison with a fermata that disrupts the musical flow. In contrast, m. 6 features greater texture depth, where the motive alternates between different voices, supported by a continuous line in the cello and bassoon. Dynamically, the opening feels abrupt and forceful whereas the generative period itself is quieter, more controlled, and refined.

D'Indy's analysis of the main theme section is limited to the opening 9 measures, suggesting an opportunity to complement his work with further exploration. Additionally, the rationale behind introducing cells before the generative periods requires further justification. In contrast, Caplin offers a complete analysis of the main theme

[1] This term can be understood in a more general sense, rather than being as specifically defined as a thematic introduction in Caplin's framework.

section, providing a structural framework that can serve as a point of comparison and reference. His analysis raises particular observations about the labeling of the opening five measures, which aligns with a similar ambiguity in d'Indy's analysis. The comparative suggests that their theories reach a partial consensus, even though they are expressed through different discourses.

Espace inutile

3.2.2 Lemma Derived From Caplin's paradox

Espace?

In analyzing the main theme section of this movement, Caplin's own analysis reveals some inconsistencies when compared to his theoretical framework. To effectively compare Caplin's analysis with d'Indy's, it is important to first address these inconsistencies. By examining and resolving these issues, a solution is proposed as a lemma, which will later be applied to facilitate the comparison.

In his 1991 book chapter, Caplin treated the first four measures as a thematic introduction and the subsequent 16 measures as a sentence [Caplin, 1991, p. 28]. This interpretation sees measures 6-20 as a very conventional, textbook-styled sentence theme-type with an even distribution of presentation, continuation, and cadential functions, much like Caplin's analysis of the main theme of op. 2, No. 1 [Caplin, 2013, p. 34]. Starting at m. 5, which is on a tonal key, this approach makes sense as it fits the typical structure of a presentation in a sentence. However, this raises a significant issue because the prominent theme of the first four measures recurs throughout the piece. In Caplin's definition, a thematic introduction doesn't actually contain the main theme but rather an accompaniment pattern or something similar, making this interpretation less convincing.

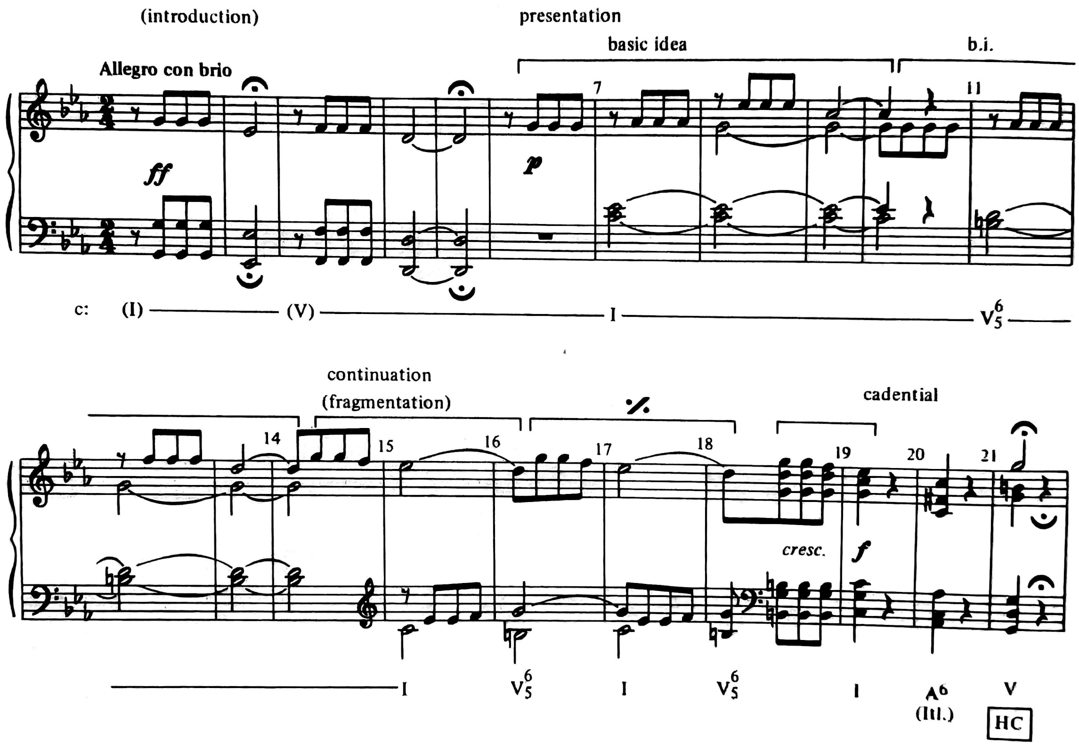

Figure 3.2: mm. 1-5 treated as thematic introduction, followed by a sentence [Caplin, 1991, p. 28].

In this analysis, Caplin stated that, "Despite the manifestly dramatic importance of the opening measures, we learn, as the music progresses, that they actually serve to introduce the main theme proper, which begins at the upbeat to measure 7" [Caplin, 1991]. However, in *Analyzing Classical Form*, Caplin says,

> "A thematic introduction is a short unit, rarely more than two measures, but sometimes just one or two chords. Its motivic content is minimal so as not to project any sense of being a basic idea. It often consists exclusively of accompanimental figurations that continue after the beginning of the theme" [Caplin, 2013, pp. 133-4],

which results in a contradiction. The motive in the opening measure is the foundation of the whole movement, even the whole symphony, which cannot conform to the purpose of "not to project any sense of being a basic idea," but rather, is more than qualified to treat them as the basic idea. As a side note, there is a matter of nomenclature; the word "thematic" could cause confusion in this case of use, as according to Caplin, a thematic introduction is defined not to have such thematic function, but rather, "often consists exclusively of accompanimental figurations."

By rejecting the opening measures as thematic introduction, such contradiction disappears, yielding another interpretation treating the first five measures as the presentation, followed by a 13-measure continuation, and then wrapping up with a cadential arrival on m. 21, shown in Fig. 3.3. This method treats the initial measures as the main theme and fits them into a broader structural framework. However, this approach complicates matters, making the continuation section much longer than the presentation. This elongation of the middle section is a feature often seen in Caplin's analyses[2], but it raises questions about the practicality and complexity of his model. The continuation section becoming disproportionately long compared to the presentation section challenges the simplicity and clarity of the model, suggesting that this interpretation might overload the analytical framework with unnecessary complexity.

[2] This study contains such an example: The exposition of "Eroica," discussed later in this chapter, where, according to Caplinian analysis, the main theme and closing section are relatively short compared to the middle section, suggesting an unreasonable disproportion.

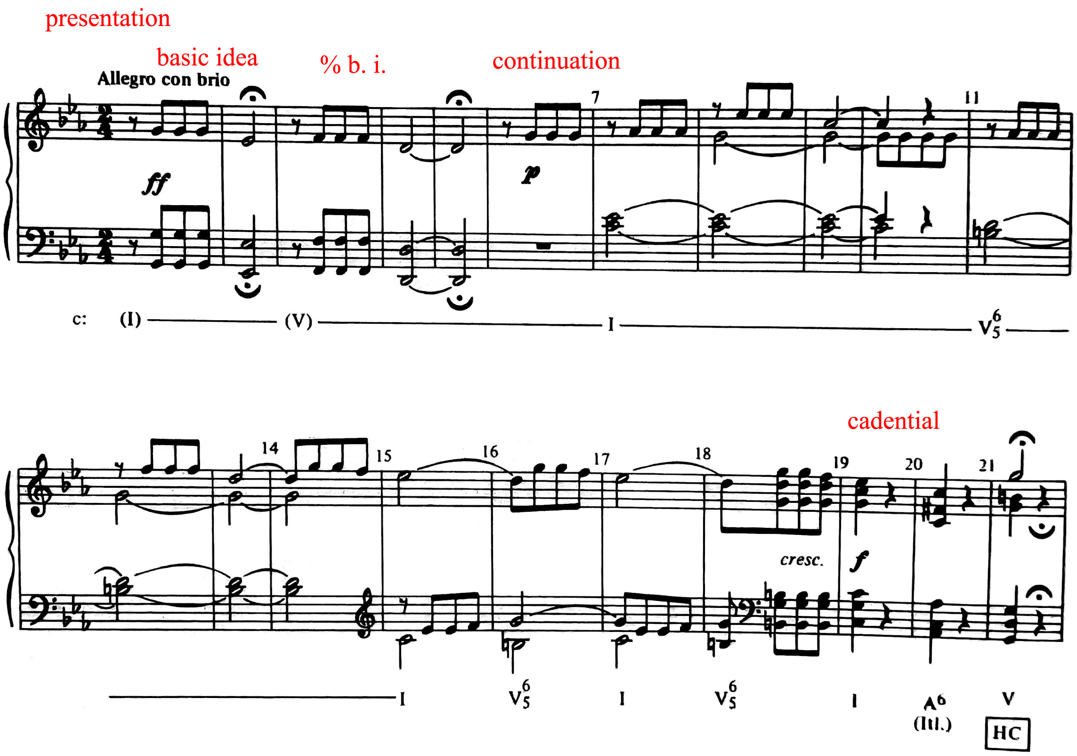

Figure 3.3: mm. 1-5 treated as main theme, followed by long continuation.

Considering these points, I find the second interpretation less appealing despite its logical coherence. It proposes a more complex model that, while seemingly fitting the structure, makes the overall analysis less practical and overly complicated. This complexity detracts from the intuitive understanding of the piece, especially since the first four measures are a recurring and recognizable theme throughout the symphony.

Therefore, while Caplin's framework offers various ways to analyze thematic structures, the specific case of Beethoven's Symphony No. 5, first movement, illustrates the challenges and limitations of fitting a prominent and recurring theme into a rigid analytical model. This example underscores the need for flexibility and adaptation in theoretical approaches to account for the unique characteristics of different musical pieces.

To resolve Caplin's paradox while remaining within the Caplinian framework, we need to develop or adopt a Neo-Caplinian theoretical model that allows for a basic idea to appear before the presentation phrase. One such Neo-Caplinian concept is Janet Schmalfeldt's notion of becoming, which accommodates situations where a basic idea transitions into a presentation phrase. Schmalfeldt extensively explores this idea in her book [Schmalfeldt, 2011], providing a flexible framework that allows the incorporation of d'Indy's insight while extending the Caplinian model to address these formal ambiguities.

Fig. 3.4 illustrates the conciliatory analysis. Treating the first four measures as a presentation aligns with Caplin's language, where the presentation presents the basic idea. The subsequent measures, starting from m. 6, can be viewed as a continuation that evolves into a nested sentence, as demonstrated in Fig. 3.4. This approach solves the problem of identifying the basic idea of the main theme without resorting to the notion of a thematic introduction. It also simplifies the model, avoiding an overly complex continuation section.

By categorizing the first four measures as a presentation and the subsequent measures as a continuation functioning as a nested sentence, we achieve a structure that is both coherent and symmetrical. This nested sentence approach ensures that the continuation section does not become disproportionately long, thereby maintaining a more balanced and "square" structure. The second presentation, contained in the continuation phrase of the first presentation, has a relatively lower level of hierarchy.

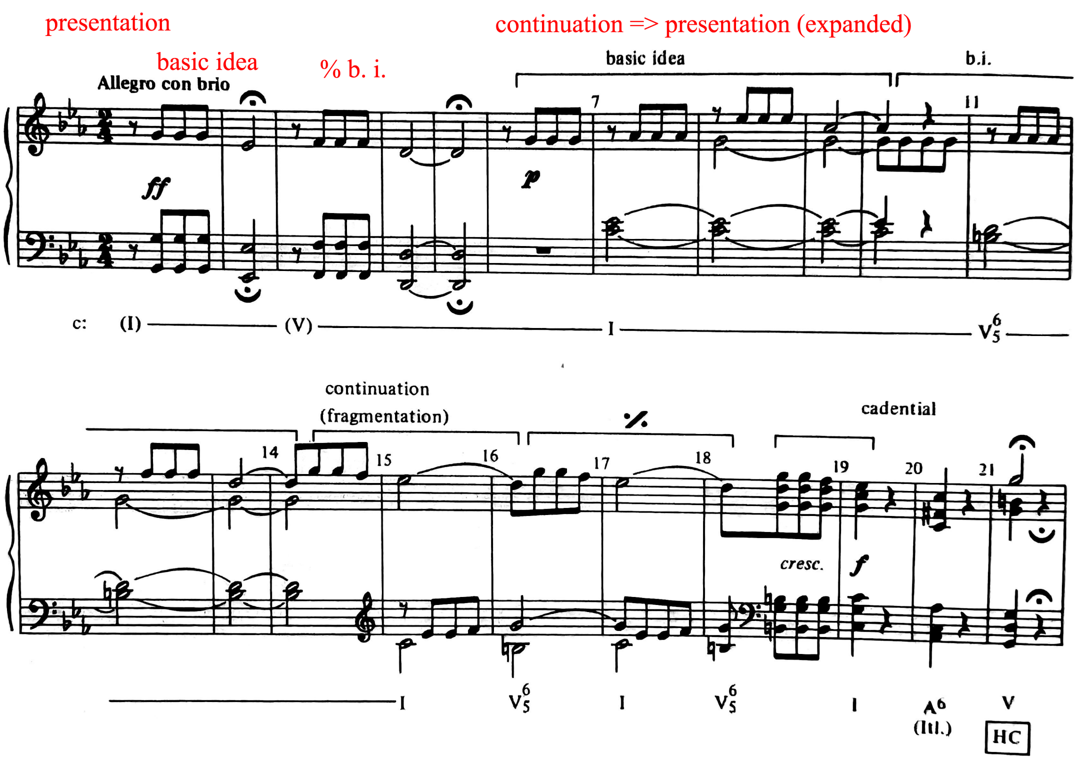

Figure 3.4: Refined Analysis of the main theme of op. 67, no. 1.

3.2.3 Comparison

D'Indy and Caplin's theories show similarities in the roles of the generative period and the presentation phrase. For d'Indy, a generative period—also referred to as the initial period, which explicitly implies a "beginning" function—generates the second and third periods to complete a Dindyist phrase. Similarly, in Caplin's model, a presentation phrase serves the "beginning" function within a strophic theme, presenting thematic content that subsequently develops through continuation and cadential phrases to complete the sentence.

Shown in Fig. 3.5, mm. 10–13 are labeled as a repeated generative period, given that they are an exact restatement of the content in mm. 6–9.[3] As a result, that

[3]This analysis is based on the earlier discussion of the Hammerklavier, where even when the second statement of the motto is slightly altered from the first, it is still considered a repeated generative period. In the current example, however, the repetition is exact, making it more accurate

Caplinian four-measure basic idea occupies the same passage as a generative period in d'Indy's terminology, and that Caplinian eight-measure presentation phrase occupies the same passage as a a group of two generative periods.

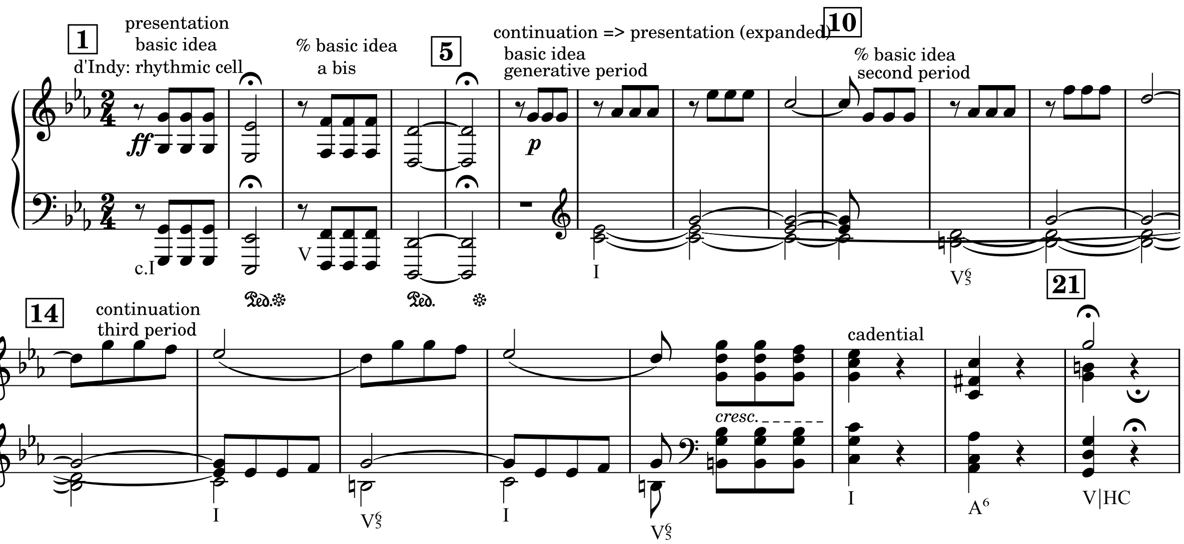

Figure 3.5: Analysis of Caplin vs Analysis of d'Indy.[4]

While the Neo-Caplinian analysis suggests a nested structure as discussed earlier, d'Indy's analysis also exhibits a nested structure where the initial four measures exhibit structural duality. On one hand, according to d'Indy's hierarchical model, a cell is part of a generative period. In this instance, however, the two cells at the beginning, to some extent, has a higher level of hierarchy than a period-contained cell because they stand on their own outside of the container. We can thus recognize that complexity arises when analyzing a compact passage with an exhaustively restated short-short-long motive, as it necessitates adapting established theoretical frameworks to account for the passage's structural ambiguity and layered hierarchies.

Such challenges may explain d'Indy's omission of discussion for the remainder of the section where the motive is repeatedly used. This repetition poses no issue for Caplin, as his analysis relies more on harmonic and formal function. For him, the half cadence in m. 21 closes the main theme, followed by a transition that develops

to label it as a faithful repetition of the generative period.

material from the main theme, structured around his preference for grouping by means of closure. In d'Indy's framework, however, the rest of this passage remains ambiguous, as he provides no analysis for these later fragments. As discussed earlier, d'Indy emphasizes grouping through parallelism. However, since the motive recurs throughout, it becomes challenging to establish distinct groupings. It is, therefore, not particularly useful to try to apply d'Indy's approach to analyze these remaining passages. This perspective is further supported by d'Indy's labeling of the transition section, which provides evidence for this interpretation.

3.3 On the transition

D'Indy labeled the transition as four measures with a straightforward assertion, which requires interpretation. Notably, there is a rhythmic stop on m. 60, which could suggest why he marked this point as the beginning of a separate formal section. However, there was also a rhythmic stop earlier in m. 21 as shown in Example 3.5, which he did not treat as the end of the main theme. One possible explanation is that d'Indy considers a continuous chunk of music featuring a succession of homogeneous materials as a single section. In this movement, the motives are varied but consistently repeated from mm. 1-60. D'Indy attempts to incorporate homogeneous material into what he considers a single theme until materials change, which is challenging since the same motive plays until m. 62. D'Indy tries to incorporate this stretch of homogeneous material into a single thematic section until there is a noticeable change in content, which is challenging since the same motive continues until m. 62.

D'Indy extends his analysis up to m. 60, interpreting the continuous use of similar materials as one cohesive unit, only recognizing the need to separate sections as the subordinate theme approaches. Instead of transitioning directly from the first thematic section to the second, d'Indy allocates four measures for the transition immediately after the rhythmic break at m. 60. D'Indy's decision reflects his desire for the exposition to follow a complete structure, encompassing the transition component.

Figure 3.6: Transition of op. 67, no. 1 (mm. 61-63) [d'Indy, 1933, p.130].

It appears that d'Indy did not operate within a framework where a functional perspective was prevalent. According to Caplin, the first cadence syntactically closes the main theme at m. 21, concluding that sentential formal section, and then transitions into a new section that utilizes homogeneous materials while modulating to the relative major.

3.3.1 Discussion

D'Indy's preference for parallelism in grouping, organizing similar materials into unified categories, creates issues when applied to Beethoven's Fifth Symphony. By reducing the transition to a mere four measures, this perspective disrupts the conventional balance and structure of the exposition, diminishing the dynamic contrast typically essential in sonata form. The more this analysis is pushed toward such an extreme, the more its limitations become apparent, as it overlooks the functional distinctions between sections in favor of surface-level uniformity.

For Caplin, however, this is not a problem. Caplin's theory does not hinge on the continuity or genesis of thematic content. Instead, his focus is on harmony, bassline movement, and the nature of cadences. These elements, rather than the thematic material, take precedence in defining form. This explains why Caplin can use Beethoven 5 as an exemplary piece to illustrate Beethovenian composition—his framework is well-suited to handle its harmonic and cadential structures, even when thematic repetition is present.

3.4 Conclusion

Providing a complete analysis of Beethoven's 5th Symphony, Op. 67, would have made d'Indy's theory of the genesis of musical ideas appear highly effective. His approach, centered on the generation and development of a core idea, aligns perfectly with this movement, where the iconic short-short-short-long motive permeates almost every section, providing a clear example of how a single cell can contribute to the generation an entire movement.

However, despite the suitability of this piece, d'Indy only briefly mentions the movement's beginning as an example of generative period. In his corpus on the nine Beethovenian Symphonies, he did not provide a thorough analysis analysis either. This is a missed opportunity, but it may have been a deliberate choice.

The reason for this omission could be that, while Beethoven's 5th Symphony provides a near-perfect demonstration of his theory, d'Indy recognized that most other Beethoven sonata movements do not share such an evenly distributed thematic consistency. Many works have more varied thematic content and a less uniform application of a single generative idea. As a result, using this piece to exemplify his theory would have highlighted its strengths in this specific context but could make his framework seem less adaptable to other sonata movements that lack such motivic cohesion.

Therefore, to keep his theory versatile and applicable across a broader range of examples, d'Indy may have intentionally refrained from overemphasizing this mouvement or other movements where his concept of genesis could overshadow the theory's adaptability. In doing so, d'Indy deliberately downplayed the unique strengths of his approach in this particular movement to maintain its broader applicability, sacrificing some sharpness and specificity in favor of flexibility.

Instead, d'Indy chose to use the Hammerklavier Sonata as his exemplar piece, as it provides a more fitting context for demonstrating his theory's handling of both unified and contrasting materials. Furthermore, it brings to light similar discrepancies between his analysis and Caplin's in terms of form labeling, which will be addressed in the following chapter.

Chapter 4

On "Hammerklavier", Movement 1

4.1 Introduction

Moving on to Beethoven's Op. 106 "Hammerklavier," this piece is also particularly notable for its striking opening theme—a 'Fanfare' motto that, despite appearing only a few times, forms the thematic core of the entire work.

Vincent d'Indy provides a comprehensive walkthrough of this sonata from beginning to end, making it the only full piece he discusses in detail within the initial movement section of his chapter. This choice emphasizes an example-driven methodology in d'Indy's approach. Similarly, Caplin offers a complete analysis of another work—Beethoven's Op. 2 No. 1—to outline his theory. Interestingly, the two scholars chose pieces from opposite ends of Beethoven's compositional spectrum: d'Indy analyzes one of Beethoven's latest and most complex works, while Caplin uses one of his earliest sonatas. The Hammerklavier is a large-scale piece with an intricate fugal texture in its development, making it a challenging candidate for any analytical theory, while Op. 2 No. 1 is much smaller in scale and adheres more closely to classical conventions. Consequently, d'Indy's theory adequately handles the degree complexities of the Hammerklavier, whereas Caplin's theory underfits when applied to such monumental works, revealing its limitations in analyzing more complex movements like the Hammerklavier.

Similar to the main theme in Beethoven's 5th Symphony, Caplin's theory encounters challenges and paradoxes when trying to label the main theme of the Hammerklavier. There is justification for both interpretations: either including the opening measures as part of the theme, which results in a theme with disproportionate phrasal lengths, or treating the initial measures as an introduction, which preserves a more balanced internal structure within the theme. In contrast, d'Indy's theory, with its emphasis on genesis of musical idea, handles this ambiguity more effectively, providing a more adaptive solution for cases where themes are particularly distinct or prominent.

Contrary to d'Indy's unconventional label in his analysis of the development section in Beethoven's 5th Symphony, it is now Caplin who introduces an unconventional form label in the Hammerklavier Sonata, challenging the scholarly consensus. Previously, d'Indy's analysis diverged from established interpretations, but for this piece, his reading aligns more closely with conventional views, whereas Caplin's interpretation breaks away. Examining these ambiguities in form labeling further reveals how each scholar's distinct methodological approach influences their interpretation.

D'Indy's theory of genesis offers certain advantages over Caplin's functional approach by providing more internal consistency when dealing with ambiguous formal boundaries. Moreover, d'Indy's example-driven methodology on a complex piece like the Hammerklavier enables him to address problematic formal divisions more effectively. Ultimately, this chapter will further demonstrate how these theoretical distinctions influence their analytical outcomes and impact our broader understanding of Beethoven's formal structures.

4.2 Comparative Analysis on the Main Theme

4.2.1 D'Indy's Analysis

The main theme, or the first idea (A) is marked by a strong affirmation of the tonic key, which is a common feature in Beethoven's compositions. D'Indy notes that Beethoven frequently begins his pieces with vigorous and repeated tonic chords, establishing a clear tonal center from the outset. In Op. 106, the initial rhythmic cell is primarily tonal and rhythmic, giving the first idea a decidedly masculine character. Despite the presence of secondary or complementary periods that may exhibit a more melodic quality, the overall thematic unity is maintained through the consistent use of this initial rhythmic cell.

This main theme exemplifies a case where cells are contained within a generative period, a standard organization of formal units as discussed in earlier in section 2.4, contrasting with the example in section 3.2.1. This arrangement also serves as a powerful tool for resolving inconsistencies in Caplinian approaches when applied to this main theme section.

It is important to note that, according to d'Indy, there are two generative periods suggested, and the period following the second generative period is referred to as a secondary period. Thus, the interpretation could be that d'Indy treats repetition, such as the statement-response repetition in this case (which is not an exact repetition), as not influencing the order of subsequent events.[1] Similar to his analysis on Beethoven's Symphony No. 5 as in 3.3, d'Indy's observation illustrates how d'Indy's judgment is guided by homogeneity, treating materials with homogeneous content as a single entity.

Given that d'Indy has not provided annotation for the content following measure 8, there is ambiguity in annotating the subsequent section as either a third period or repeating the second period, considering d'Indy's insensitivity to repetition. For the sake of convenience and logical consistency, where the second would logically be followed by a third, I label m. 10 as the beginning of the third period in Fig. 4.3.

[1] Exact repetition and statement-response repetion are Caplinian terms [Caplin, 2013, pp.41-4].

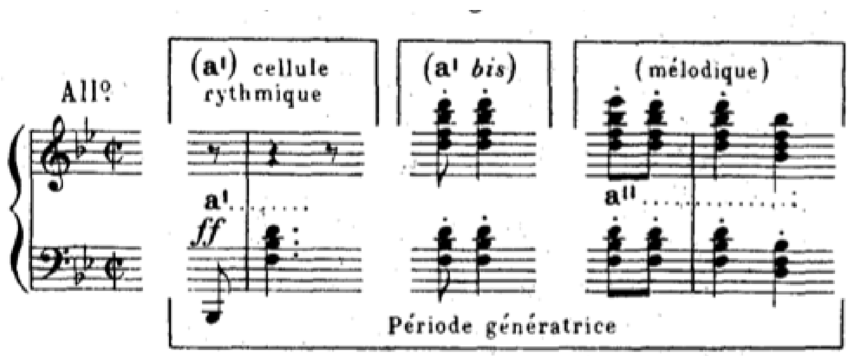

Figure 4.1: mm. 1-4 treated as two rhythmic cells, contained in by a generative period [d'Indy, 1909, p. 236].

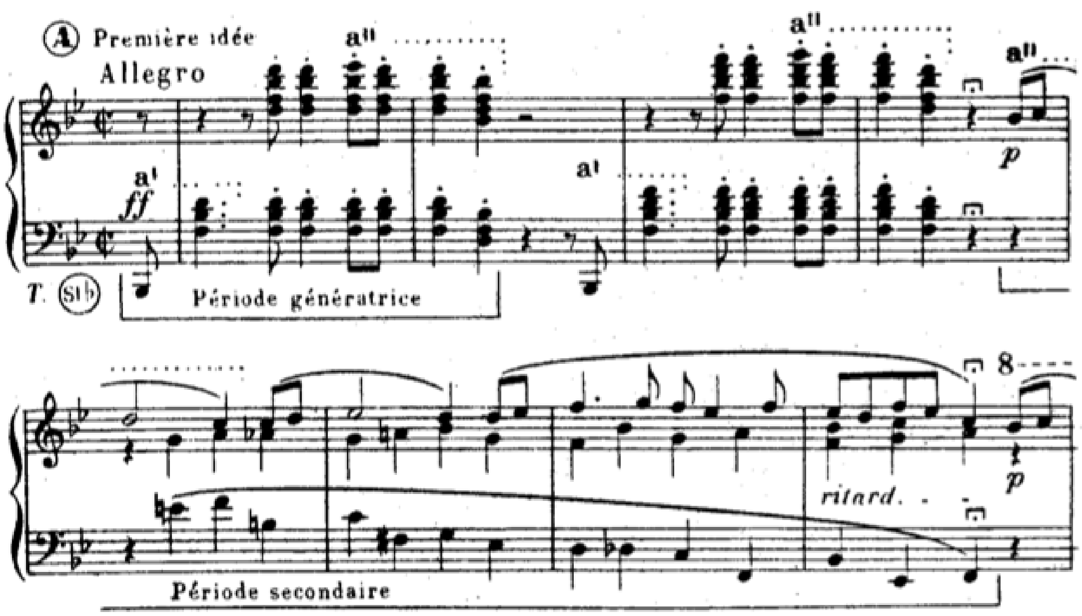

Figure 4.2: D'Indy's analysis on the opening measures[d'Indy, 1909, p. 264].

4.2.2 Caplinian Analysis

Similarly, there is ambiguity in labeling the opening four measures as the presentation phrase of the main theme or as other elements, such as a thematic introduction.

Labeling the opening measures as a thematic introduction poses challenges because the "fanfare" motto is so distinctive in the piece, despite not occurring frequently. It is precisely this motive that has led to the piece being recognized and titled as the "Hammerklavier." This motive is also relatively more thematic compared to the subsequent passage, which, due to the contrast, does not possess thematic importance. Moreover, m. 5 begins on a dominant harmony, further weakening its thematic claim.

Similar to the paradox of Caplin's analysis on Beethoven's 5th Symphony, there are two ways to interpret it within the Caplinian framework, of which the first one, labeled as "Caplin 1" in Fig. 4.3, consists of treating the opening four measures as the presentation, with the following measures serving as the continuation, leading to a half cadence in m. 8. Following the half cadence, the continuation returns using the "one more time" technique, extending further to reach a perfect authentic cadence (PAC) in m. 17.

However, considering the relationship between the two cadences and the homogeneity of materials beginning in m. 5 and m. 9, it suggests a periodic theme type with an expanded consequent. This analysis, labeled as "Caplin 2" in 4.3, maintains a more balanced structure.[2] The half cadence on m. 8 leaves the preceding phrase with unresolved tension, necessitating a **response** rather than a simple "one more time" restatement, which would fail to convey the sense of closure and balance expected from a well-formed period. Labeling m. 9 as the start of a consequent phrase suggests that the tension created by the half cadence in m. 9 is resolved, following the call-and-response dynamic typical of a periodic structure.

4.2.3 Comparison

We observed challenges in applying Caplin's theory, particularly regarding harmonic syntax. The harmonic rhythm of the main theme is relatively high and dense compared to classical repertoire, with 3–4 chords per measure throughout mm. 5–17. This characteristic aligns with Caplin's description of Romantic music, as discussed in [Caplin, 2018], which he describes as having a uniform harmonic rhythm and density, and increased use of chromaticism and dissonance. This even

[2] Using the annotation style suggested in [Hentschel et al., 2024], which allows for the concurrent representation of multiple analyses on the same piece.

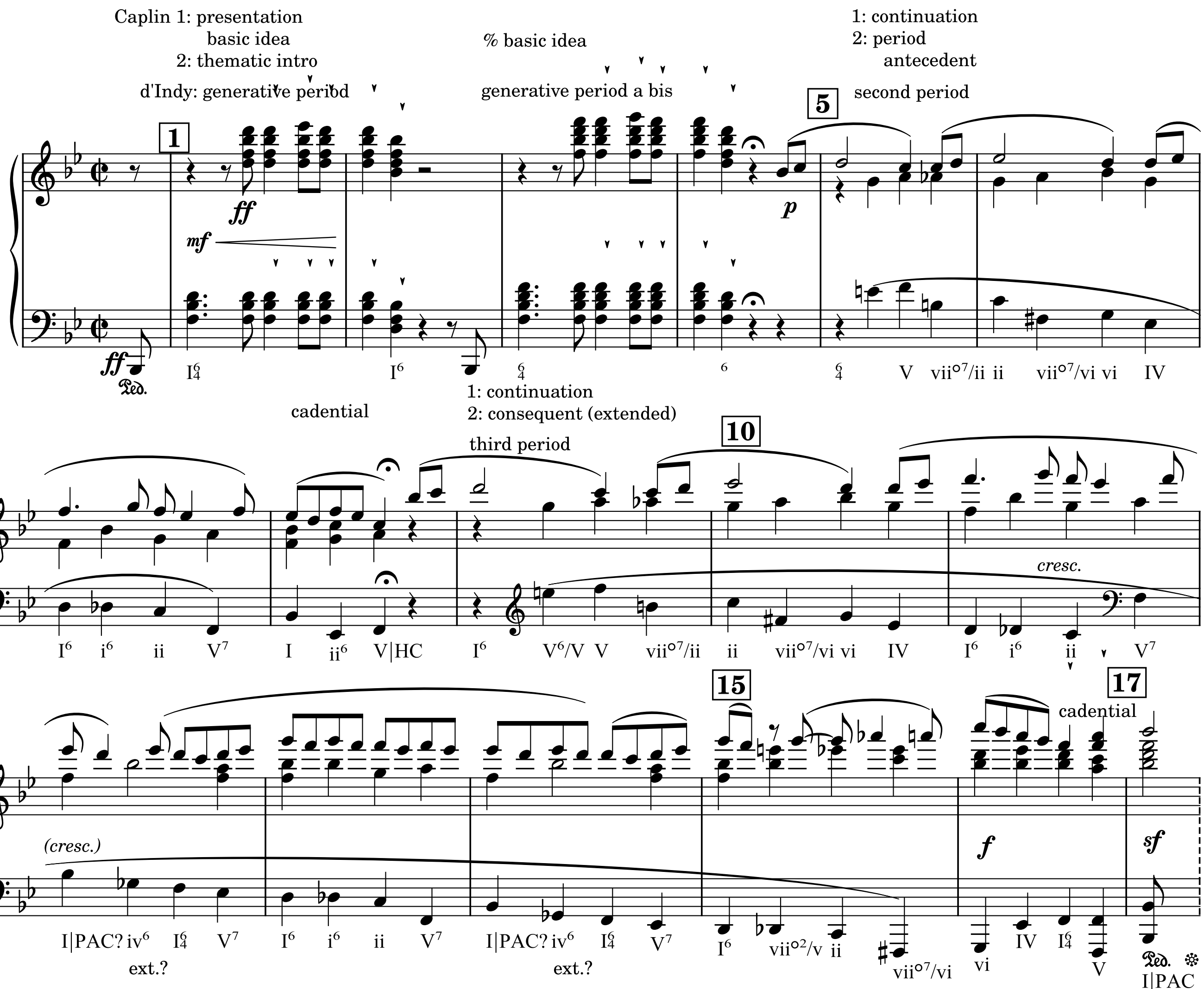

Figure 4.3: Caplin's and d'Indy's analyses of the main theme of op. 106, no. 1.

density complicates the distinction between cadential and post-cadential material, creating ambiguity as to whether measures 13 and 15 should be treated as abandoned cadences with extensions. As a result, Caplin's harmonic rules do not fully apply here. Instead, the basis for grouping defers to parallelism rather than Caplin's preferred harmonic syntax, shifting the analysis closer to d'Indy's perspective.

While Caplin's analysis similarly features a nested structure, d'Indy's analysis here presents a flatter configuration, interpreting the main theme section as a succession of three periods. This perspective introduces certain limitations. As discussed earlier in Campos's critique of d'Indy's tendency to exagerate the role of generation, d'Indy here places perhaps too much emphasis on the generative period. His discussion primarily centers on thematic resemblance between the generative period and the subsequent second and third periods. In contrast, Caplin's analysis incorporating antecedent and consequent highlights a statement-response relationship between what d'Indy refers to as the second and third periods. Rather than relying on a single source or origin, considering materials as emerging from a succession of references, each building on the previous one, would yield a more constructive analysis.

4.3 On Where Begins the Subordinate Theme

4.3.1 D'Indy's Analysis

D'Indy's analysis places significant emphasis on the transition (P), dividing it into three distinct elements. He acknowledges that this transition is notably longer and more complex than in many of Beethoven's earlier works. The initial element of the transition (mm. 18-34) is derived from the rhythmic cell of the first idea, ending with a dominant pedal on m. 31, shown in 4.4. The second element (mm. 35-45) uses the generative period to modulate to the dominant of the relative key, G major, with some modal mixture, shown in 4.5. The final element (mm. 45-63), shown in 4.6, is a long melodic line over the dominant of the new key, preparing for the introduction of the second idea [d'Indy, 1909, pp.265-8].

The second idea (B) in Beethoven's exposition is characterized by its melodic, insinuating, and supple nature, which stands in contrast to the more rhythmic and assertive first idea. D'Indy explains that the second idea generally consists of three distinct but interrelated phrases.

The first expository phrase (mm. 65-74), shown in 4.7, is derived from a melodic cell of the first idea and consists of three periods in G major [d'Indy, 1909, p. 269]. This phrase sets the stage for the second idea, maintaining thematic continuity.

The complementary phrase (mm. 75-99), shown in 4.8 also subdivides into three periods. The first phrase resolves on the dominant, the second shifts toward the subdominant and is followed by an episodic recall of the cell (a'') from the initial idea (A), and the third phrase returns to the tonic [d'Indy, 1909, pp.270-1].

A third conclusive phrase (mm. 100-120), shown in 4.9, remaining on the tonic harmony, is also composed of three periods, where the first two being directed towards the subdominant and forming a double plagal cadence; and the third, with a more agogic character, follows a perfect cadence [d'Indy, 1909, p.272].

4.3.2 Caplin's Analysis

In his paper "The Expanded Cadential Progression," Caplin labels the section starting at m. 47 (d'Indy's third element of Transition) as the subordinate theme without justifying but simply asserting it, shown in 4.6. The subordinate theme is identified as a significantly expanded sentential structure, featuring two expanded presentation phrases occurring consecutively. This repetition draws parallels with d'Indy's repeated generative period. Both presentation and generative periods serve as initiating units, typically appear once but, in this case, are repeated in succession.

Figure 4.4: Entry - mm. 17-34

-VD: First element of P

-WC: Part 1 of TR?

Figure 4.5: Entry - mm. 35-46

-VD: Second element of P

-WC: Part 2 of TR?

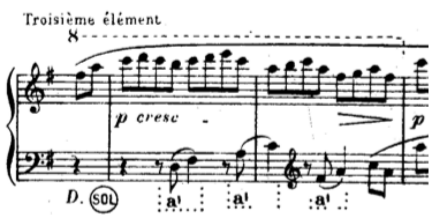

Figure 4.6: Entry - mm. 47-63

-VD: Third element of P

-WC: Compound Presentation of ST

Figure 4.7: Entry - mm. 63-74

-VD: First Phrase of B

-WC: Continuation in ST

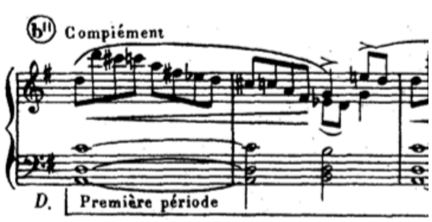

Figure 4.8: Entry - mm. 75-100

-VD: Second Phrase of B

-WC: ECP of ST

Figure 4.9: Entry - mm. 100-123b

-VD: Third Phrase of B

-WC: Closing Section of ST

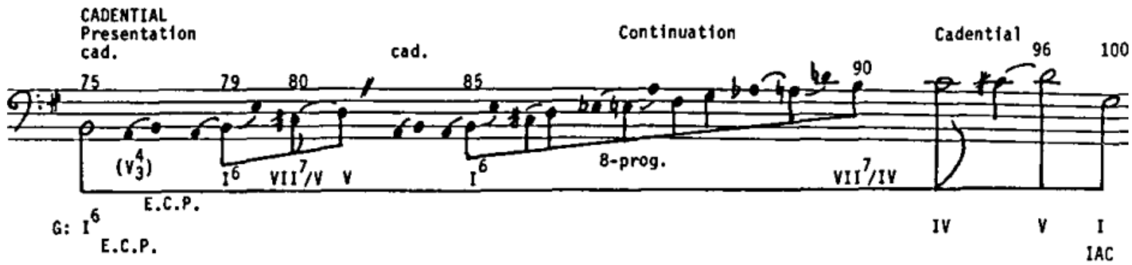

Figure 4.10: Bassline sketch of the expanded cadential progression [Caplin, 1987, p. 242].

A large continuation section begins in m. 63 (d'Indy's first phrase of the second idea), shown in 4.7, with a new four-measure antecedent-like phrase, which briefly modulates to the dominant region, confirmed by a perfect authentic cadence in m. 66. This antecedent fulfills a genuine continuational function due to its fragmentation relative to the repeated eight-measure presentation and the marked acceleration in harmonic change. This new phrase begins to be repeated like a consequent but becomes fragmented through sequential repetitions in m. 70 and further in m. 74, leading to a I6 chord where the expanded cadential progression (ECP) begins.

This first-inversion tonic, sustained by accented neighboring chords in measures 75-78, initiates the expanded cadential progression, shown in 4.8 and corresponding to d'Indy's second phrase of the second idea. This progression is interrupted by an evaded cadence on m. 81, followed by another nested and expanded sentence, ultimately culminating in a final imperfect authentic cadence on m. 101. A subsequent closing section (d'Indy's third phrase of the second idea), shown in 4.8, ends the exposition on m. 126.

4.3.3 Discussion

The passage in mm. 63-76, where d'Indy identifies the beginning of the second musical idea, Caplin instead labels it as part of a continuation. Caplin's analysis characterizes this continuation section as containing a nested period, complete with a cadence closing the antecedent. While this interpretation appears to contradict Caplin's theoretical framework—which states that "the sentence form has no cadential articulation prior to its closing cadence" [Caplin, 2004, p. 58]—it may instead reflect a deliberate sacrifice of theoretical strictness. Here, Caplin seems to overturn his own principles in favor of a more flexible and creative analysis, adapting his theory to account for the complexities of the music rather than forcing the music to conform rigidly to the theory.

Vincent d'Indy's perspective on the exposition in Beethoven's "Hammerklavier" Sonata, Op. 106, differs notably from William Caplin's analysis, but aligns more closely with the views of other scholars such as Sterling Lambert, who posits that

> the transition passage [on mm. 47-63] simply prolongs this dominant by means of a descending melodic turn at measure 47, prior to a cadence in G major (m. 63) that ushers in the first theme of the second group. [Lambert, 2008, p. 450]

He suggests that this passage acts more as a preparatory section, delaying the arrival of the subordinate theme and thus contributing to the sense of temporal suspension and indeterminacy. Besides, David Greene also supports this analysis but by objecting Caplin's interpretation. He argues that,

> If G were established as a tonic before these paired phrases (47–63) began, [these paired phrases] would be analogous to the second theme in other movements. But instead, [these paired phrases] serve to tonicize G, in order that the pair of subphrases in bars 63–66 and 67ff. may function as a second theme. [Greene, 1982]

Green's articulation is implicit but aligns with d'Indy's interpretation, where he states,

> This third element, which ends the bridge, is merely a long melodic line over the dominant of the key of G, replacing that of G minor, and producing a very noticeable increase in brightness. [d'Indy, 1909, p. 268, *translation mine*]

Both Greene and d'Indy favor theme arrivals that coincide with the establishment of the local tonic harmony and view tonicizations as belonging to pre-thematic content. However, d'Indy introduces an additional layer of analogy by connecting the harmonic shift to a perceived increase in "brightness," thereby adding a more expressive dimension to the formal interpretation.

4.4 Conclusion

By introducing perspectives of various scholars, it becomes evident that d'Indy's approach to the "Hammerklavier" Sonata's exposition aligns more closely with the broader scholarly consensus.

While Caplin's analysis provides a detailed structural breakdown, it is met with significant counterarguments, and it might be due to his objective to find cadential progression that is expanded for discussion. Given that expanded section extends 25-measure long from mm. 75-100, the presentation and continuation phrases are expected to be proportionally expanded, leading to an elongated subordinate theme section. This necessity might require Caplin to reach over to earlier materials, leading to the inclusion of the content from mm. 47-63 within the elongated sentential structure. His approach of embedding cadences within an expanded presentation phrase reflects a process in which he prioritizes one theoretical perspective while temporarily sacrificing the strict adherence to another.

D'Indy's interpretation is not constrained by the need to fit a preconceived theoretical model. Although d'Indy engages in existential discussions about musical ideas, his analytical choices remain largely independent of these overarching theories. This separation allows for greater stability and flexibility in his analysis, making it less prone to the interpretative issues that arise when theory takes precedence over the music itself.

In conclusion, Caplin's analysis is theory-oriented, as he works within an existing theoretical framework and occasionally sacrifices aspects of that framework to fit the example at hand. In contrast, d'Indy adopts an example-oriented approach, building his theoretical insights directly from the music itself. While Caplin prioritizes adapting theory to accommodate the example, d'Indy allows the example to embody and shape the theory, resulting in an analysis that feels more grounded in the music and less constrained by external theoretical structures.

Chapter 5

Conclusion

In conclusion, d'Indy engages in extensive theoretical discussions about the genesis and evolution of musical ideas, outlining concepts such as generative periods. His theories demonstrate a preference for homogeneity and dualistic structures, analyzing musical differences through binary categories like gender, specifically "masculine" versus "feminine" themes. He also employs numerical methods to generalize structural organization. These approaches are not purely about form—they connect with broader cultural and ideological convictions, including his recorded views on race and nationalism.

Yet, when it comes to actual analysis, d'Indy often sets these broader principles aside, allowing the details of the piece to shape his interpretation rather than forcing the music to conform to his theoretical constructs.

During d'Indy's era, theoretical approaches to music were characterized by a broad scope of abstraction, where theories could encompass a wide range of musical phenomena, often without strict boundaries. This allowed theorists to explore and articulate musical principles in a more expansive and sometimes speculative manner. In contrast, contemporary music theory has become increasingly specialized, focusing on more narrowly defined areas of study. This specialization reflects a significant paradigm shift in the field, where the emphasis is now on depth rather than breadth, applying rigorous methodologies to specific aspects of music.

Given these contrasting methodologies, we can view d'Indy's and Caplin's theories as representing two distinct discourses, as exemplified in my comparative analysis. While d'Indy's theory can offer valuable insights into Caplin's framework, it does not directly replace or function as a fully developed alternative. Instead, d'Indy's ideas serve as complementary perspectives that help inform and refine Neo-Caplinian approaches, rather than standing as a substitute.

But has music theory truly transformed so completely? Despite criticisms that place d'Indy's work in an old-fashioned theoretical discourse, there are moments where his methods appear remarkably avant-garde. His comprehensive walkthroughs of Beethoven's sonatas and symphonies reveal a proto-structural approach that foreshadows aspects of modern corpus studies, demonstrating a forward-thinking methodology that aligns with current analytical trends.

Furthermore, beyond his existential discussion, in analyzing "Hammerklavier," d'Indy's approach is firmly rooted in the descriptive details of a specific musical example. The analytical part, somewhat segregated from his broader theoretical discussions, resulting in a focus on labeling and categorizing sections without attempting to draw strong arguments. The overall tone, filled with descriptions, resembles a flat, almost scientific publication, lacking the rhetorical embellishment or grand interpretative statements often found in more theory-driven texts.

In contrast, Caplin's analysis of the Hammerklavier is clearly theory-driven, aiming to illustrate an extreme case of an expanded cadential progression, even if doing so places his interpretation at the fringes of the broader scholarly consensus and occasionally stretches the framework's applicability to fit the piece.

Addressing the issue of disciplinary focus, Joseph Kerman remarks,

> In fact, it seems to me that the true intellectual milieu of analysis is not science but ideology. [Kerman, 1980, p. 314]

Caplin's approach, then, seems to fall into a form of interpretive bias, driven by the need to validate his theoretical model of expanded cadential progression. Whether these analytical claims are empirically grounded or not, they are shaped by an underlying preference for a particular interpretive lens. A parallel can be drawn to d'Indy's use of the number three: although numbers are ostensibly neutral and measurable, choosing specific numerical patterns to represent musical form and assigning them symbolic significance are subjective acts influenced by broader conceptual beliefs.

Caplin's theory, developed and popularized through his textbooks, is heavily example-based, but it is still shaped by certain selective choices and constraints. Developed from the classical repertoire of Haydn, Mozart, and *early* Beethoven, this analytical framework may struggle when applied to Beethoven's late compositions, where its effectiveness diminishes, leading to more disagreement among scholars.

Moreover, the harmony in the "Hammerklavier" presents additional issues. As illustrated in 4.3, the harmonic rhythm accelerates, reflecting a Romantic style, which, according to Caplin, deviates from the classical harmonic syntax [Caplin, 2018]. This shift questions the applicability of Caplin's classical cadential models in the context of late Beethoven. Melodic content could potentially be more reliable as reference for determining formal section, as did Vincent d'Indy.

Consequently, for analyzing Beethoven's late work, a relatively independent analytical needs to be adopted, like d'Indy's one. His chapter uses "Hammerklavier" as a starting point, demonstrates a more adaptable framework for analyzing late Beethovenian work.

Yet he also stumbles by choosing a piece that is not truly representative of Beethoven's output. The Hammerklavier Sonata, with its massive scale and complexity, is an outlier, and using it to substantiate d'Indy's theories risks overfitting his analytical model to a single, highly atypical work. This choice limits the broader applicability of his ideas, making it difficult to generalize his framework to more standard Beethovenian forms. For instance, while d'Indy categorizes the Hammerklavier's transition into three distinct elements, he struggles to maintain similar degree of complexity in subsequent analyses, such as Beethoven's 5th Symphony, where his labeling reduces the transition to just four measures.

In his Cours de composition, d'Indy jumps from pre-Beethovenian sonatas to

Beethoven's late works, using pieces like the Hammerklavier Sonata, which features a fugal development section—an unconventional occurrence even within Beethoven's own sonatas. Using such a monumental and atypical piece to substantiate his theories introduces an overly complex angle, raising the question: does it genuinely bridge the gap between the works of Beethoven's predecessors and his own highly evolved structures? Addressing this gap by analyzing more transitional works could provide valuable insights into how d'Indy's theoretical framework might be adapted or extended to bridge the stylistic and formal evolution from early sonata forms to Beethoven's mature compositions.

Finally, given d'Indy's engagement in music pedagody, this raises a critical question: is this redundancy reflective of his teaching philosophy? Does his pedagogy fall into a similar trap of focusing on the most complex and extreme examples, leaving students equipped only for exceptional cases while lacking the tools to handle more conventional ones? If so, his methodology might produce students who are highly skilled at dissecting intricate pieces but struggle to apply these techniques to standard repertoire, creating a disconnect between theory and practical utility. Exploring whether d'Indy's teaching approach shows similar tendencies would open up new avenues for understanding the strengths and potential limitations of his broader pedagogical framework.

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